



TECHNICAL REPORT

Senso Comune Gallery

Design, commerce and compliance

Unique paintings, sold from mainland China to buyers at home and abroad. What follows is what that costs, what it requires, and what is still unresolved.

Prepared for Priscilla

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Repository `senso-comune-gallery`

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PART 1

Summary

1.1 What this is

A site selling unique paintings — six in the catalogue at the time of writing, priced \$60–\$440 — run by one non-technical person resident in mainland China, addressed equally to international and domestic buyers.

That last sentence contains most of the difficulty. A gallery site for a handful of works is an afternoon’s work. A gallery site for a handful of works that takes money across the Chinese border, ships physical objects internationally, satisfies two consumer-law regimes at once and loads acceptably on both sides of the Great Firewall is not.

Nothing in the build is fixed to six. The counts, the series and the page set are all derived from the work data; adding a seventh work, or a new series, is a data edit.

1.2 Where things stand

Table 1: The site on 21 September 2026

Built	36 pages, 18 in each language: the homepage, the catalogue and its two series, six work pages, sold works, and seven pages of information
Published	A preview on GitHub Pages: not indexed, labelled on every page, and unable to take an order
Ready to sell	No. The readiness gate counts 54 details still owed (Section 5.5.4), and a release refuses to build until they are supplied
Checked	Five checks on every build, and a sixth in a real browser (Section 5.4)
Contrast	AA, on both grounds. The plates are off and the wall is dark, so the ink ladder was re-solved for it: <code>--body</code> measures 4.92:1 on <code>--field</code> and <code>--muted</code> 4.62:1, against a floor of 4.5 (Section 2.3.1). The darker green admits exactly one ink — 4.55:1, where pure black would reach 4.65 — and carries two things now: the About panel and the band under the masthead (Section 2.2.6, Section 2.7.7). The contrast check solves both greens as ordinary grounds, so a regression on either blocks the build
Still to build	The buy box and disclosures on the work page, and the cart, search and account — none of which has a control on the site any more, by decision (Section 6.6)

1.3 The seven findings that would have sunk it

Table 2: Blocking findings, all now dealt with in the build

Finding	Where
Every call to action was #A19E97 — 2.67:1 , failing both the body-text and the large-text floor. No font size rescues it.	Section 2.2
Stripe is unavailable to a mainland-China seller — the whole account, not merely PayPal. Airwallex excludes mainland entities from card acquiring and opens no individual accounts at all.	Section 3.1
vercel.app and workers.dev measure 100% blocked from mainland China. pages.dev measures 0%.	Section 1.4
A unique pre-existing painting gets no returns exception under either Chinese or EU law. Uniqueness is not personalisation.	Section 4.1
Instagram was the only contact channel. It is blocked in mainland China, and EU law requires an email address regardless.	Section 4.2
China-origin paintings are not duty-free into the United States. Section 301 adds 7.5% and the \$800 de minimis exemption is suspended.	Section 3.3
A one-page site cannot link to one painting, which is the site's main acquisition motion.	Section 2.7

1.4 Decisions taken

Settled

Launch as an individual, with the Hong Kong entity reachable as a configuration change rather than a rebuild. Under CNY 100,000 annual turnover there is no business-registration requirement, no foreign-exchange quota consumed, no balance-of-payments filing and no VAT.

Host on Cloudflare Pages. The only option with no bill, no pause, no terms problem and no ICP filing.

A page for everything that is shared. Every work, series and policy has its own address in both languages; two lines of CSS (`@view-transition`) keep the calm of a single page when moving between them.

Self-host the fonts. 81.7 KB for both families, built from the variable originals, plus 31.3 KB of italic that is fetched only where an italic is set.

Adopt Priscilla's sage palette — all of it. The walls are her sage, held at a lightness that can carry prose; cream is kept for the mat around a painting and paints no page surface (Section 2.2.2).

The plates are off, and the type was re-solved for what is left. The reading surfaces are transparent, so the field is the only background colour on the site; the lightness ladder that made those surfaces readable is still in the token file, still solved, simply not painted (Section 2.2.3). Reading on a mid-tone then decided the ink: every text colour was re-solved against the wall, the lit fall was flattened because its foot could not carry an ink at all, and the accent was demoted to fills and large text (Section 2.3.1). The contrast check treats the wall as an ordinary ground, so all of it blocks the build.

And weight finished what colour could not. On #898D76 pure black reaches 6.14:1, so the ladder above is at its ceiling and there is no contrast left to find; what is left is mass, because a stroke on a mid-tone ground loses to irradiation in a way it does not on paper. Set as a specimen against the same text on #EBEFDB, Inter at 400 breaks up and at 500 reads as emphasis, and Fraunces at 400 loses its hairlines outright: the site runs 450 for the sans and 500 for the serif set as prose, and both go back to 400 the day the plates come back (Section 2.3.7).

The ground is a switch, and it is kept in both positions. #EBEFDB is still the surface that measures best, and the page is not read on it — that is a decision about what this site looks like, not about what is legible. So every value the paper ground needs sits commented beside the value the wall needs, in six pairs, and `check-contrast` reads the plates and solves whichever is on screen. Neither state can ship unmeasured (Section 2.2.4).

1.5 Cost

Table 3: Running cost of the recommended build

Item	One-off	Annual
Hosting (Cloudflare Pages)	\$0	\$0
Domain (registrar at cost)	—	\$11
Fonts, licensing (SIL OFL)	\$0	\$0
Analytics	\$0	\$0
Photography, phone build	\$6–25	—
Photography, full build	\$360–400	—
Copyright registration, batch	\$85	—
Total, minimum viable	\$6–25	\$11

Payment processing is separate and depends on the entity decision; see Section 3.1.

PART 2

Visuals

Everything the site is looked at through: its colour, its type, its mark, its surfaces and edges, the shape of the pages and the review they were put through. Each is a subsection below, and each carries the research it was decided on rather than a summary of it — the measurements, the failures, and what was rejected, so a decision can be re-opened on the evidence that made it.

2.1 Where the design came from

Priscilla supplied a nine-page draft and, later, a live mockup with a revised palette, having already built a prototype on Netlify. All three were treated as the brief. The work here was not to redesign but to find where the drawing and the medium disagree — and they disagreed mostly about contrast.

2.2 Colour

Priscilla's mockup moves the site from white to a sage-green world: a dark brown mast-head bar, warm brown text, terracotta, and cream plates behind the paintings. Two of her decisions were already right and are kept exactly as drawn — the warm browns, and a **filled** terracotta button.

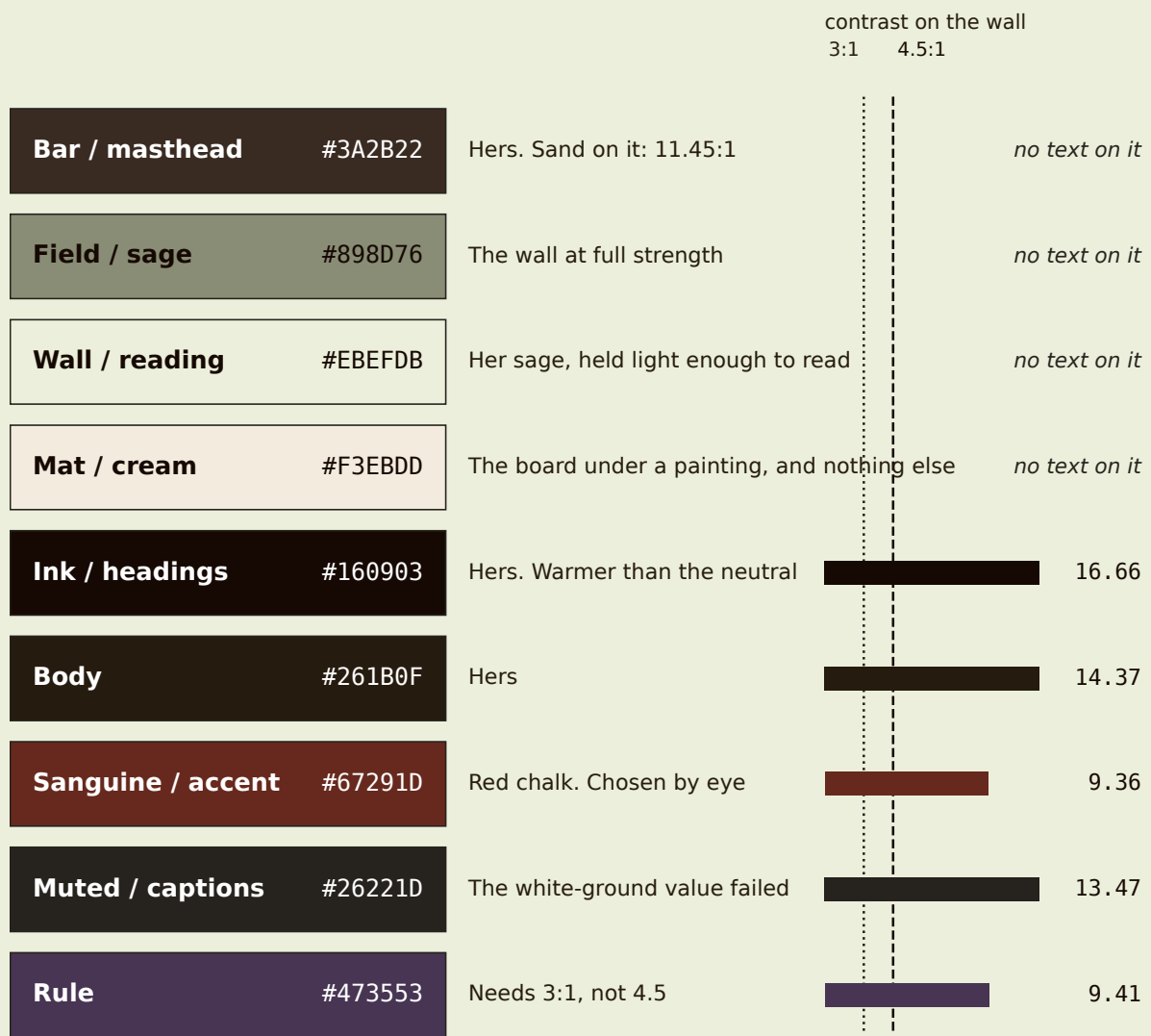


Figure 1: The palette as built. Each value is read from the project’s token file, not transcribed.

2.2.1 What could not be adopted as drawn

Body text on the sage does not pass, and the accent on sage is worse than the value it was replacing.

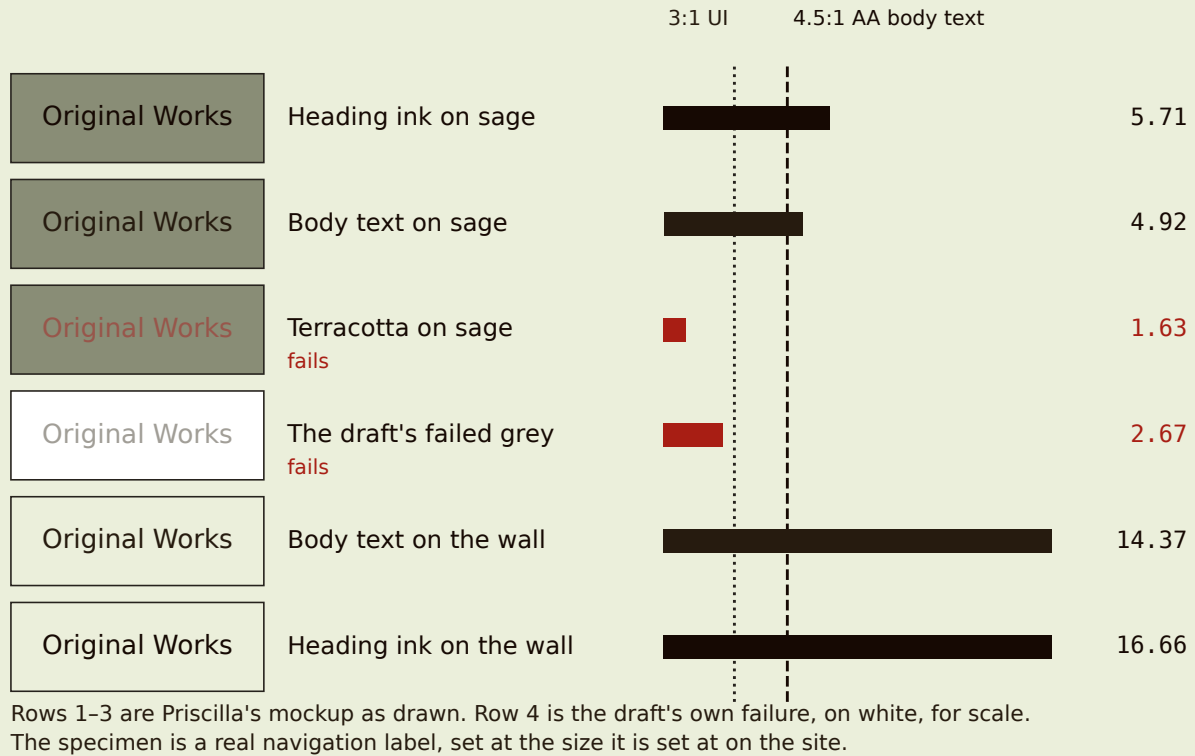


Figure 2: Why the sage carries no text. The three red bars are Priscilla's mockup as drawn; the draft's original failure is included for scale.

The resolution was already in her own mockup

She sets the paintings on light cream plates against the sage. So sage becomes the **field** and a light plate the **reading surface** — the whole content column is a sheet mounted on sage, which is what a gallery does to a work on paper anyway.

Her green stays dominant at the margins, and nothing sets text on the field.

That sheet was cream for the first three months of the project. It was sage for an afternoon — Section 2.2.2 — and by that evening it was painting nothing at all: Section 2.2.3.

2.2.2 Sage as the reading ground

Decision of 20 September 2026, and the research behind it.

The brief for this pass was one line: restrict cream to the backgrounds of the art pieces, and put everything else on sage and its variations. That is a bigger request than it sounds, because Section 2.2.1 is the reason the reading was on cream in the first place — her sage measures 2.35:1 under body text.

So the first question is not *which* sage but **what the failure was actually about**. It is answerable by measurement rather than by taste. Solving every foreground the site sets on a reading surface — nine of them, at their own floors — over a grid of candidate grounds in the plane of the field's own hue gives Figure 3, and the finding is the shape of the boundary:

The line is **flat**. A reading ground fails on **lightness** and on nothing else. Below L^* 91.5 the binding pair is `--muted-ui` at 3.0:1 — an icon stroke, not prose — and above it, **chroma is free**: a ground can carry the field's full chroma of 0.043 and `--muted-ui` still measures 3.05:1.

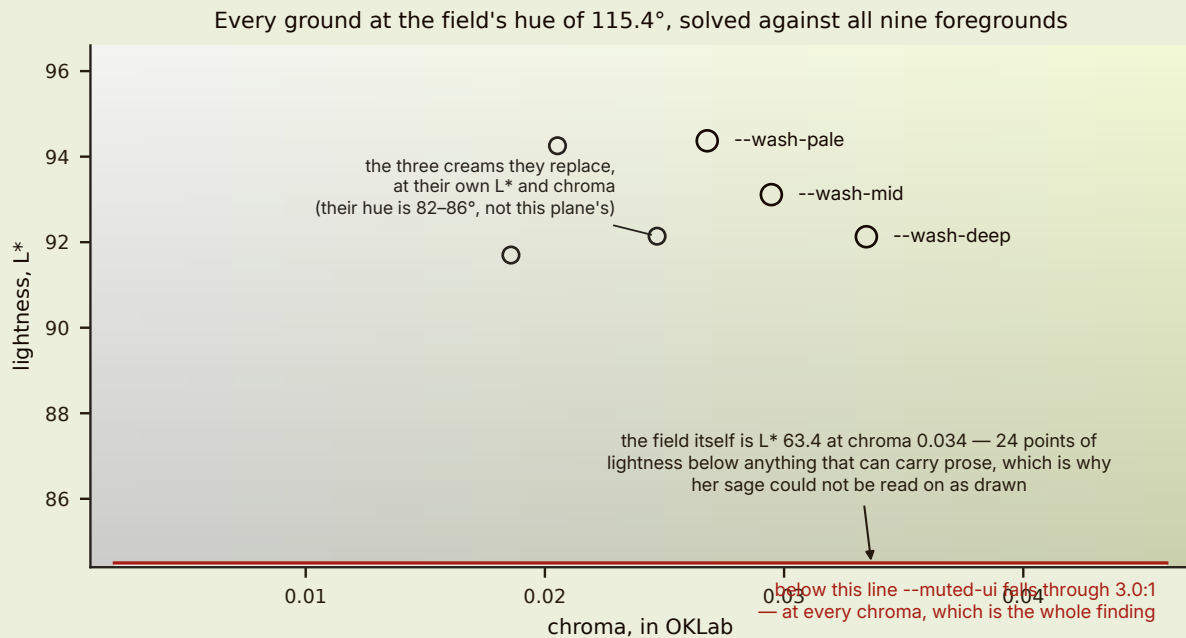


Figure 3: Where a reading ground may live. Every cell is a real colour at the field's hue; the veiled region is what `check-contrast.mjs` refuses.

Which makes the move obvious and cheap: **keep the lightness ladder that was already measured safe, and rotate its chroma onto the field's hue**. The three grounds do not move up or down, so not one of the ~60 pairs the contrast check solves had to be re-solved. They are better than they were:

Table 4: The three reading grounds, before and after. Not one foreground token moved.

Ground	Was	Now	<code>--muted-ui</code> on it	<code>--body</code> on it
<code>--wash-pale</code> (the sheet, Works)	#F3EBDD cream	#EBEFDB	3.24 → 3.27	5.73 → 5.78
<code>--wash-mid</code> (Tribute)	#EDE4D3 cream	#E7EBD5	3.04 → 3.15	5.38 → 5.57
<code>--wash-deep</code> (About)	#E9E3D6 cream	#E4E8CF	3.00 → 3.06	5.31 → 5.41

The old names — warm, violet, blue — were inherited from washes that had been gone for months; all three were cream. They are now named for the only thing that separates them, which is lightness.

Every ratio in that table is measured with the **ink of that morning**. The ink ladder was re-solved the same evening, for a wall rather than a plate (Section 2.3.1), so a plate now

carries far more than the table claims — `--body` on `--wash-pale` is 14.37:1, not 5.78:1. The comparison is left as it was made, because what it was demonstrating is that moving the grounds onto the field's hue cost nothing, and that is still exactly what it shows.

Every value in that table is still in the token file, still solved and still checked. None of them is currently **painted**: Section 2.2.3.

Then where does cream go? It keeps the job it was drawn for in her mockup and gives up the one the build invented for it. Cream paints:

- the **mat** around every painting, and the same mat around the video and the thumbnails — a board is a different material from a wall, and one step of hue is what says so: against `--wash-deep` the mat is dE 1.8 in OKLab, a boundary you can see and cannot name;
- the box that holds an image before its bytes arrive;
- **light ink on the dark bar** — the wordmark, the navigation, the 12 % wash under a hovered control;
- the focus halo, which has to survive being drawn over a dark painting.

It paints no ground that anyone reads on. `check-review.mjs` L-01 holds that by listing every rule allowed to paint cream — fifteen of them — and failing on a sixteenth, so adding one is a decision rather than a slip.

One new token came out of it. The frosted plate behind the contact panel was `--paper` at 72 %, which on the palest ground made it *the same colour as the thing it was laid on*. It is now `--wash-lift`, one step lighter than every ground, so the plate is visible on all three and still cannot darken what is read on it.

2.2.3 The plates, switched off

Decision of 20 September 2026, later the same evening.

The brief for this one was also a line: make the backgrounds behind the text transparent, so that nothing of #EBEFDB shows anywhere and the only background colour on the site is the sage. It is Section 2.2.2 read backwards. That pass asked what a reading ground may be; this one asks what is left when there is none.

Nothing was deleted to do it. A background that is edited away is an afternoon's work to put back, and the request was explicitly for a switch rather than a demolition. So every surface that is read now paints a token of its own, and those tokens are what is transparent:

Table 5: What paints a surface that is read

Surface	The rule	The token	Painted
The mounted content column	<code>.sheet</code>	<code>--plate-sheet</code>	transparent
Works, How to Buy, the hero	<code>.ground--pale</code>	<code>--plate-pale</code>	transparent
Tribute	<code>.ground--mid</code>	<code>--plate-mid</code>	transparent
About	<code>.ground--deep</code>	<code>--plate-deep</code>	transparent

Surface	The rule	The token	Painted
A boundary between sections	.edge--*	both neighbours' plates	transparent
Behind an opened work	dialog.lightbox::backdrop	--plate-lightbox	--field at 94%

Putting the paper back is those four values and one more, with no rule touched: `--plate-sheet` and `--plate-pale` to `var(--wash-pale)`, `--plate-mid` and `--plate-deep` to their own washes, and `--edge-breath` to 20%. Any other value is equally available — one section can be given a ground of its own, in a colour that is not in the ladder at all, without opening the stylesheet.

Two details are worth the words. **A band's ends are the plates of the sections either side of it, not the washes those plates happen to hold** — which is what keeps the finding of Section 2.5.3 true through a change of plate: a boundary cannot fade to the wrong neighbour because it does not know what colour its neighbours are. And `--edge-breath` goes to 0%: a band exists to join two grounds through the field, and with no grounds to join, a fifth of the sage laid over the sage would be invisible in the middle of the fall and a faint horizontal smudge at either end of it. The bands keep their 9 rem, which is section spacing, and paint nothing.

The lightbox is the exception, and has to be. A backdrop exists to hide the page behind an opened work, so transparent is not available to it. The equivalent of letting the field through is the field itself, at the same 94%.

What it costs. The washes exist for a reason, and it should not be possible to switch them off without reading the bill. Every foreground the site sets on a reading surface is now read on the field, and the field is the one surface in this palette that was never solved for text. It is also lit — `--field` at the top of the fall, `--field-deep` at the foot — so both columns below are real grounds on the same page, not a range.

Table 6: What the plates cost the palette **as it then stood** — the ink of the morning, read on the wall of the evening. This is the bill that forced the type re-solve of Section 2.3.1, and every figure in it has since been superseded.

Token, as it was	On --wash-pale	On --field	On --field-deep	Floor
--ink #3A2B22	11.56	3.96	2.65	4.5
--body #66594B	5.78	1.98	1.33	4.5
--muted #69655E	4.94	1.69	1.13	4.5
--sanguine #8B4A3C	5.70	1.95	1.31	4.5
--muted-ui #858279	3.27	1.12	1.33	3.0

That was quietness bought with contrast, which is the one thing this report opens by forbidding: the draft failed its review because every call to action was `#A19E97` at 2.67:1, and `--body` on the field was worse than that at both ends of the page.

It stays in the record in those terms because it is what made the type re-solve necessary, and what the re-solve had to beat. It did: the ladder of Table 13 clears every floor on the

wall, the fall was flattened because its foot could not carry an ink at all, and the accent was demoted to fills and large text. The plates being off is no longer a contrast debt; it is a constraint the type is now solved inside.

What the check does about it. `check-contrast.mjs` reads the plate tokens, and when any of them is transparent it adds the **wall** to the grounds every foreground is solved against — so with the plates off, `--field` is checked exactly as a plate is, and a regression on it blocks the build. That is a change from the morning, when the same block could only *print* the bill and say it could not certify the page: there was no ladder that passed. There is now (Section 2.3.1), so the check binds instead of reporting. Beside the verdict it still prints the headroom — how much of the wall’s own budget each rung is using — because the budget is what will bite if the wall moves again.

`check-review.mjs` L-05 holds the mechanism rather than the value: the five plates must be declared, the five rules that paint a ground must name them — the bands are G-06’s — and **no rule anywhere may name a wash directly**. A hardcoded `--wash-pale` in a rule is how a surface falls out of the switch and stops being reversible, which is the only way this decision could quietly become permanent.

What is still painted. Cream keeps the mat, the image box and the bar (Section 2.2.2, L-01), and the frosted contact panel keeps its `--wash-lift` at 72%. That panel is now the one plate left on the site, and the arithmetic of Section 2.5.5 has turned around with it: over the field it composites to #D3D6C4, where `--body` measures **4.58:1** at the top of the fall and 4.23 at the foot. The plate that could only ever make text paler is now the most legible reading surface on the site.

And the mount goes with the plate. The sheet kept a shadow and a rim light for a while — the pair that says a sheet is lying *on* the field rather than being a hole cut in it. With `--plate-sheet` transparent there is no sheet lying there: the pair drew a 1240 px rectangle, filled with the field’s own green, whose edges corresponded to nothing anybody could see. That reads as a rendering fault rather than as a mount, so it is `--mount-sheet`, it is *none* on the wall, and it comes back with the paper.

2.2.4 The switch, kept in both positions

#EBEFDB is the surface that measures best and the site is not read on it. That is a decision about what this gallery looks like rather than about what is legible, and a decision of that kind should be reversible by someone who is not holding this document.

So the paper ground is kept, commented, beside the wall ground, in six pairs. Five are in `tokens.css` and one in `base.css`; the file’s own header indexes all six, because a switch scattered across six places is a slow switch however well each place is commented.

Table 7: The ground switch. Nothing else has to be re-solved: the ink ladder clears its floors on both.

	On the wall	On paper
<code>--plate-sheet / -pale / -mid / -deep</code>	transparent	<code>var(--wash-*)</code>
<code>--edge-breath</code>	0%	20%
<code>--rule-soft</code>	#A2A593	#D6DAC4
<code>--wght-text / --wght-prose</code>	450 / 500	400 / 400

	On the wall	On paper
--mount-sheet	none	shadow + rim
The Leonardo hatch (base.css)	7%	4%

Three of those six are the same observation in different materials. A mid-tone ground takes strokes, so the weights move (Section 2.3.7). A decorative line’s quietness is a *ratio* and not a colour, so both the hairline and the hatch move: #D6DAC4 measures 1.22:1 on #EBEFDB and 2.39 on the wall — twice as present, and plainly a line — while the hatch was measured at 7% on sage at L* 57 and carries half again the contrast on a ground at L* 93. And a transparent sheet has nothing to cast a shadow from, so the mount goes.

check-contrast reads the plates and solves whichever ground is on screen, so neither position can ship unmeasured. Both were built and checked before this was written: with the paper values uncommented the site builds, the contrast gate solves #EBEFDB instead of the wall, and every assertion, readiness test and painting box passes — then back to the wall, clean.

2.2.5 The wall, re-solved against the prototype

Decision of 20 September 2026, after the plates came off.

With the plates transparent the field stopped being a margin and became the whole page, and at that size it read fresher and lighter than the site Priscilla had been looking at — the Netlify prototype she had built before this work started. The brief was to make it *more vintage, and a little less saturated, like the prototype*.

So the prototype was measured rather than matched by eye. Its wall is a **flat #868E6E**, and the measurement contains a surprise worth keeping in the record:

Table 8: The three greens, in OKLCh. What reads as vintage in the prototype is the lightness; its chroma is *higher* than her sheet’s, not lower.

	L*	chroma	hue
The sheet’s Primary Sage #969B7D	67.7	0.043	115.2
The prototype’s wall #868E6E	63.1	0.047	119.2
--field, as now built #898D76	63.4	0.034	115.4

The rest of the capture was sampled too, because moving a wall toward the prototype is only an improvement if what stands on it already agrees — and it does, with one deliberate exception:

Table 9: Everything else measured off the same capture. dE is OKLab.

In the prototype	The token beside it	
masthead bar #3C2D24	--bar #3A2B22	dE 0.79 — the same brown, already

In the prototype	The token beside it	
button fill #A2675C	--sanguine #8B4A3C	dE 9.1, and not adopted : cream on the prototype's lighter terracotta is 3.83:1, which fails a button label. The deeper value carries 5.64:1
the wall, top to bottom	--field → --field-deep	the prototype's wall is flat ; the site keeps its lit fall, which is a decision of its own (Section 2.5.5)

The new wall sits dE **1.38** from the prototype's, where the sheet's sage sat at 4.61 — so the page is now within a step of the green Priscilla had been looking at, and the step that remains is the saturation she asked to come down.

The wall therefore takes the prototype's **lightness** and the asked-for step down in **saturation** — 21 % under the sheet's chroma, 28 % under the prototype's — and does not move in **hue**, because the three reading grounds are locked to the field's own hue within two degrees (check-review.mjs L-02), and rotating a wall nobody reads on would have meant re-solving four grounds that are not currently painted. --field-deep follows it down by the same interval, so the fall the field carries is unchanged in shape.

The first departure from the sheet

Her brand sheet states **Primary (Sage Green) #969B7D** and **Deep Green #737C61**, and until this pass those were --field and --field-deep *exactly* — the palette's one perfect quotation. They are not any more.

The reason is that the wall changed job. A colour chosen as the margin around a sheet of paper is not automatically the right colour for every pixel of every page, and that is what it became when the plates went transparent. Her values remain the brand's: the mark is drawn against them (scripts/mark.mjs), the report's sheet table quotes them, and print uses them.

What the site cannot have is two greens that are nearly the same. L-06 therefore solves the two places the wall is written out in full — the lightbox backdrop's fallback for engines without color-mix(), and the installed app's splash ground in the web manifest, which is JSON and cannot hold a token — against --field itself, so a wall that moves again cannot leave a stale copy of itself behind in a lightbox or on a splash screen.

It cost contrast, and the type paid it. A darker wall under the same ink is a smaller ratio: --ink went 4.70 → **3.96** and --body 2.35 → **1.98**, which is the state Table 6 records. That bill is what forced the ink ladder to be re-solved the same evening — a new value for every text colour, a flat wall instead of a lit fall, and an accent that no longer sets small text (Section 2.3.1). With the plates painted none of it would have signified; it signified because they are off, which is the other half of the same decision.

2.2.6 The panel, and what that green admits

Priscilla asked for one section to be painted: About, in “**Dark Sage**” #727A5C, a darker cut of the wall, so it reads as a panel set into the page rather than as another stretch of it. The plates made that a one-line change — it is exactly the case the indirection was built for (Section 2.2.3) — and the colour made it the most constrained surface on the site.

That green is the exact centre of the mid-tone squeeze. The wall is a mid-tone with a ceiling (Section 2.3.1); this is a mid-tone with barely a budget at all. Measured:

Table 10: What #727A5C carries

Ink	On the panel	Verdict
pure black #000000	4.65	the ceiling for dark text
pure white #FFFFFF	4.52	the ceiling for light text
--ink	4.33	fails 4.5
--body	3.73	fails
--muted	3.50	fails
--paper	3.81	fails
--sanguine	2.43	fails even 3.0
--sanguine-deep	3.50	fails
--muted-ui, --rule	2.44, 2.45	fail 3.0

Every rung of the ladder fails on it, in both polarities, and the whole of colour space has about **3 % of headroom**: nothing can do better than pure black’s 4.65. So either the colour moves or the ink does, and the colour was the request.

--ink-deep #080301 is what the panel is set in: 4.55:1 on the green, 5.99:1 on the wall, the ladder’s own hue, and the only value that clears the floor with anything to spare. Lightening the green instead was solved and rejected — the ladder needs a ground at $Y \geq 0.249$ and the wall is already at 0.257, so the darkest sage that carries --muted is within one L^* step of the wall and would not read as a panel at all.

What it costs is the section’s tonal hierarchy. Everything inside the panel is that one ink: the heading, the prose, the caption under the portrait, the link and its hover. There is no quieter grey for a caption on this ground and no terracotta to hover into, so size, weight, small caps and the underline carry what colour used to. That is stated in the stylesheet beside the rule, in --ink-deep beside the token, and asserted by N-03 — and the contrast check solves the panel as a ground of its own, so nothing else can be painted on it without being solved for it first.

2.2.7 The warm-ground trap

#767676 is the canonical “lightest grey that passes on white”. On pure white it passes at 4.54:1, with 0.04 to spare. Warm the ground at all and it fails.

This caught the project three times — twice in tokens written specifically to avoid it. The response was to stop checking by eye: `scripts/check-contrast.mjs` recomputes every token against **the darkest ground it is ever painted on** and fails the build on a regression.

2.3 Typography

Two open-source variable faces, self-hosted: Fraunces and Inter.

Table 11: Font build, measured rather than estimated

Build	Bytes
Fraunces, all four axes	121,124
Fraunces, opsz 14–40, wght 400–700, WONK 1	51,868
Fraunces, opsz pinned	32,500
Fraunces, SOFT axis kept live	91,304
Inter, opsz 18, wght 400–600	29,856
Total, both families, latin subset	81,724
Fraunces Italic, opsz 14–30, wght 400 — not preloaded	32,080
Fraunces Italic, wght 400–700	58,344

Two corrections came out of running the build rather than reading about it. The draft sets Fraunces at six optical sizes — 16.0, 16.8, 21.6, 27.2, 30.4 and 38.4 — so the opsz axis must stay live; pinning it saves 19 KB and flattens the optical sizing the design depends on. And Fraunces' WONK axis defaults to **1, not 0**; pinning it to 0 changes the letterforms to save 140 bytes.

2.3.1 The ink, re-solved for the wall

Decision of 20 September 2026, and the reason the type section carries a colour problem at all.

Type colour is normally settled once with the palette. It had to be re-solved here because the ground moved twice in a day: the plates went transparent, and then the wall went darker — Section 2.2.3 and Section 2.2.5 — and between them every word on the site ended up on a **mid-tone**, which is the one kind of ground that is hard for text in both directions.

Table 12: What the wall can hold at all. A mid-tone is squeezed from both ends: too dark for light text, too light for anything but a very dark ink.

On --field #898D76	Ratio
Pure black on it	6.14 the ceiling for dark text
Pure white on it	3.42 light text is impossible — it cannot reach 4.5:1 at any value
The ink budget for 4.5:1	luminance $Y \leq 0.0182$
The ink budget for 3.0:1	luminance $Y \leq 0.0523$

Her warm brown #3A2B22 is Y 0.0274. On a cream plate it is 11.45:1 and on the wall it is 3.96:1 — which is a heading colour and nothing else. So the ladder keeps her **hue exactly** and drops its lightness until each rung clears the floor it has to carry:

Table 13: The ink ladder, re-solved. “On a plate” is --wash-pale, for when the plates are painted again.

Token	Was	Now	On the wall	On a plate	Carries
--ink	#3A2B22	#160903	5.71	16.66	headings, primary text, links
--body	#66594B	#261B0F	4.92	14.37	running text
--muted	#69655E	#26221D	4.62	13.47	captions, tombstone meta
--sanguine-deep	#63352B	#40150D	4.61	13.45	small accent text, hover, sold
--ultramarine	#2E3A8C	#151566	4.61	13.45	the Tribute accent
--sanguine	#8B4A3C	#67291D	3.21	9.36	fills, rules, large accents
--muted-ui	#858279	#3F3C35	3.21	9.38	icon strokes, borders
--rule	#8E7B9C	#473553	3.23	9.41	rules that carry meaning

Three things follow from that table, and none of them is a preference.

The lit fall had to go flat. The field ran from --field at the top to --field-deep at the foot, fixed, so the page was lit. At the foot, --field-deep holds **4.10:1 for pure black** — there is no ink, of any colour, that a paragraph could be set in there. One wall is one contrast problem and it is solvable; two walls are not. The fall returns with the plates, and --field-deep stays defined meanwhile: it is the sheet’s Deep Green, and the mark is drawn against it.

The accent cannot set small text. No red-brown that is still a red-brown reaches 4.5:1 on this ground — at that floor it is a maroon indistinguishable from the ink. --sanguine is therefore solved to the 3:1 tier and paints fills, rules and large accents only: the three-line drop cap on About keeps it, the contact panel’s top border keeps it, the scale diagram’s strokes keep it. Everything smaller takes --sanguine-deep at 4.61:1, and **links take the ink** — the underline was already doing the work of distinguishing them (technique G183), and the hover is what carries the accent now.

The ink is darker than the bar. --ink and --bar were the same warm brown, which was one of the palette’s neatnesses. The bar is still hers and still carries cream at 11.45:1, but the ink had to leave it: #3A2B22 cannot be read on sage, and the bar cannot be darkened without leaving the brown the prototype and the sheet agree on (Table 9).

What holds it. check-contrast.mjs now solves every one of these against the wall as an ordinary ground rather than printing a bill beside them — with the plates off, wall is in the grounds list, so a regression blocks the build like any other. check-review.mjs L-07 holds the accent’s division of labour by naming the two rules allowed to set --sanguine as text, and it earned its place immediately: it caught a breadcrumb and a series card still setting the accent at caption size.

And the principle the whole ladder rests on is the one the report opens with — *buy quietness with size and whitespace, never with contrast*. The colour budget on this wall is spent; what is left to build hierarchy with is size, weight and space, which is what the scale (Section 2.3.5) is for.

2.3.2 The italic the site was faking

The site sets italic in four places — the hero's Dutch original, the Tribute epigraph, and every work title, both in the list and as an `h1` — and shipped no italic file, so the browser slanted the roman by 12° in all four. A synthetic oblique of a high-contrast serif is a poor imitation of a drawing that already exists: Fraunces' italic is a different letter, not a tilted one, with a single-storey *a*, a cursive *e* and a -16° angle the letterforms were made for.

It is now a real file, and the axes are narrowed harder than the roman's because its uses are known exactly: `opsz 14–30` covers every size an italic is actually set at, and one weight, because no italic on this site is bold. That is **32,080 bytes**; keeping 400–700 would have been 58,344 for nothing. It is deliberately *not* preloaded — nothing above the fold waits on it — and `font-synthesis-style: none` now says the browser may not invent the style anywhere else either, including for the Chinese face, which has no italic and should not be given a slanted one.

2.3.3 About, set as a book page

About is the only page on the site that is nothing but prose. It was set in the interface face, at interface size, in a column the same shape as How to Buy — a form with an essay in it.

The first question was whether it needed a new typeface, and the answer is on the record with numbers rather than as a preference:

- **A third family** was rejected on the same grounds as Section 2.3: every render-blocking file is another thing to go wrong in a Chinese TCP handshake.
- **Fraunces' SOFT axis**, kept live, would soften the terminals — and take the roman from 51,868 to **91,304 bytes**, +76 % on a preloaded file, for one page's worth of prettiness.
- **Old-style figures and small caps** were the obvious next reach, and Fraunces simply has neither: its whole GSUB is `case, liga, rvrn, ss01`. So "10 %" is set in the lining figures the face draws, and nothing is faked.

What the page is set in, then, is the face the site already preloads — at the one size where that face is the same **reading size** as the sans it replaces. That size is not a matter of judgement either. Measured off the shipped subsets, at their own optical sizes:

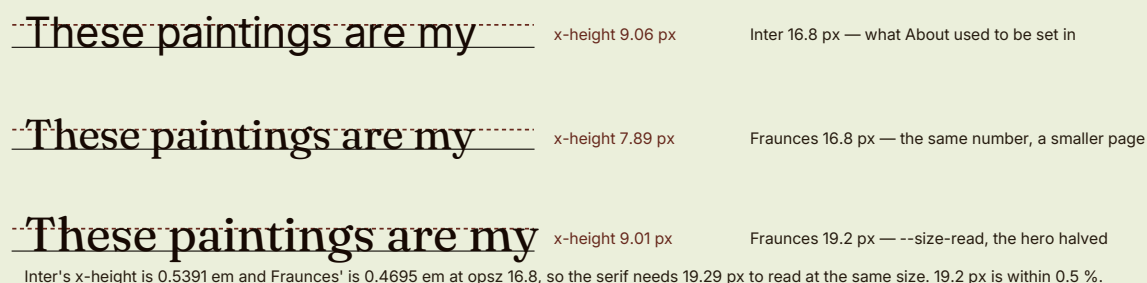


Figure 4: Why 19.2 px. A serif set at the sans's point size makes a page of prose quietly smaller; x-height is what a reader sees.

19.2 px is also where the type scale already put it — the hero halved (Table 14) — so the page gains a reading size without inventing a step.

Four moves, three of which cost nothing to download: the display face at `--size-read` with `opsize` tied to it; a **lede**, the first paragraph at `--size-mark` in `--ink`, so the page opens with a voice; a **drop cap** of three lines in sanguine, behind an `@supports (initial-letter: 3)` test so it simply does not happen where the property is unsupported; and the van Gogh quotation that closes the page set in the **real italic**, which `build.js` marks by wrapping the quoted span.

Two details are about the Chinese page, and both are refusals. It gets no drop cap and no italic, because neither is a Chinese typographic device and both would be synthesised. And it is **not** set in `--font-display`: that stack begins with the subset Noto Serif SC, which carries only the ~100 CJK glyphs that appear in display positions, so a page of Chinese prose set in it would render some characters in Noto and the rest in the system face — one paragraph, two typefaces. `--font-read-cjk` is a stack of system serifs instead, so the Chinese About page gets a book face for nothing, and gets it consistently.

2.3.4 The Chinese face, and what is not served

The display face is subset to the characters that actually appear in display positions — headings, work titles, UI labels: **34 KB, cut from a 24 MB face**. `unicode-range` gates the fetch, so an English page never downloads a byte of it, and a character Priscilla adds before the next build falls through to the system face rather than rendering as tofu.

Chinese **body prose is deliberately not webfont-served**. The system serif is already on the device and costs nothing across a border, which matters more on this site than a uniform drawing does.

That decision has one trap in it, and the token file carries the note: the Chinese About page cannot be set in `--font-display`, because that stack begins with the subset Noto Serif SC. A page of Chinese prose set in it would render the ~100 subset characters in Noto and everything else in the system face — one paragraph, two typefaces. It takes `--font-read-cjk` instead, which is system serifs all the way down, so the book page is consistent and free (Section 2.3.3).

2.3.5 The scale

Not the golden ratio. The one proportional system in Leonardo's own hand, on the *Vitruvian Man* sheet, is whole-number fractions of height.

Table 14: Type scale, and how close Priscilla's draft already was

Role	Fraction	Computed	Draft used
Hero	1 (the height)	38.4 px	38.4 px
Section heading	less 1/8	33.6 px	30.4 px
Sub-heading	less 1/4	28.8 px	27.2 px
Wordmark	1/6 + 1/4	22.4 px	21.6 px
Body	the unit	16.8 px	16.8 px

Role	Fraction	Computed	Draft used
Caption	less 1/4	12.6 px	13.1 px

2.3.6 The three display steps move with the column

Those three heads are 1.14 and 1.17 apart, which is under the interval at which a reader sees a *level* rather than a size, and then there is a 1.71 drop to body with nothing in between. All of it was fixed px, so the motto was 38.4 px on a 390 px phone and 38.4 px on a 1920 px display: the layout grew and the voice did not.

The fractions are kept as the **ends** of each step rather than as one value. Every rung still lands on the draft's own size at the width it was measured at, and moves between them with the column:

Table 15: The ladder as rendered, in px

	390	900	1440	1920
Hero	26.9	40.2	54.0	54.0
Section	24.0	27.7	35.3	38.4
Sub-head	21.6	22.2	25.4	28.3
Body	16.8	16.8	16.8	16.8

What bounds the top end is the motto, which is set as written and may never be re-wrapped (Section 2.7.7). `opsz` stops being pinned with the sizes: with no one size to pin it to, `font-optical-sizing` drives the axis from the size actually used — which is what pinning it was approximating, and the reason the axis was kept live in the font build at all.

2.3.7 Weight, which is the ground's business

A size ladder is not the whole of setting type on a mid-tone ground. With the ink already at the wall's ceiling — pure black reaches 6.14:1 on #898D76, so Section 2.3.1 has taken every point of contrast there is — the remaining variable is stroke weight, because a dark letter on a lit ground loses to irradiation in a way it does not on paper. The ground bleeds into the letter; the remedy is mass, not colour.

It was decided by specimen rather than by rule: the same paragraph, set on `--field` in `--body`, against the same text on #EBEFDB.

Table 16: What the wall does to a stroke, measured by eye against paper

Setting	On the wall
Inter 400 at 16.8	Stems break up, the counters close — as originally shipped
Inter 450	Solid, and still unmistakably a regular — adopted
Inter 500	Reads as emphasis rather than as running text

Setting	On the wall
Fraunces 400 at 19.2	The hairlines all but vanish
Fraunces 500 at 19.2	The serif holds — adopted

The serif needs more of the correction than the sans, which is what the specimen was for: Fraunces' thin strokes are the first thing this ground takes. Headings stay at 400 — display sizes pay almost nothing to irradiation — but through a token, so a ground that moves moves them too.

Both go back to 400 on paper. The correction belongs to the ground, not to the typeface, which is why it is one of the six pairs in Section 2.2.4 rather than a new fact about Inter. `font-synthesis-weight: none` was already set, so 450 is a real interpolation of Inter's live axis and the system CJK face this stack falls through to rounds to a weight it actually has, rather than being emboldened by the rasteriser.

2.4 The mark

The site had a wordmark and no mark. On a business whose entire acquisition motion is a link in an Instagram or a WeChat bio, the surfaces that render most often are a browser tab, a share card and an avatar — and none of them can render a wordmark.

The mark it now carries is Priscilla's own: an interlocking **SC** monogram, drawn, with a prototype sheet that arrives with a construction, a palette, four variations and a minimum size already worked out. **The site uses that artwork itself** — her drawing, cropped and resized, never redrawn.

2.4.1 The constraint that used to decide it

The wordmark translates: *Senso Comune Gallery* in English, 常识画廊 in Chinese. A favicon, by contrast, is chosen by **origin**, not by page: one file serves both URL trees, so a site cannot ship one mark per locale however much it would like to.

The first mark took that to its conclusion and carried no letterforms at all — a work on a wall, three rectangles and a hanging line — on the argument that SC is not the initials of 常识画廊 and would therefore serve one audience and decorate the other.

Why that argument no longer holds

Finding C-04 asked for the Latin wordmark to be kept constant in both locales, and was **closed by decision**: Priscilla keeps 常识画廊 as the Chinese name, because it reads as native to the domestic audience and that is worth more than one lockup in two languages.

That decision is what frees the mark. A monogram is not a translation of a name — it is a *device* that stands beside one, and a device does not have to be readable as the name it accompanies any more than a crest does. The Latin device beside the Chinese name is the arrangement most international houses use in China. What is not allowed is a mark that says a *different* name in each locale, and the build asserts that the lockup is byte-identical on the English and Chinese homepages.

2.4.2 The sheet, as drawn



Figure 5: The prototype sheet, reproduced as supplied — brand/brand-sheet .png.

Construction and proportion, the hatching detail, the four variations, clear space and minimum size, the four brand colours, and the horizontal and vertical lockups.



Figure 6: The preferred option, reproduced as supplied — `brand/mark-lockup.png`.

This is the artwork the site uses: the monogram with its construction lines, over the word-mark. Everything the build ships is a crop and a resize of this one file.

Both files live in `brand/`, unmodified, and are pinned by hash: re-exporting or tidying either one fails the build and has to be a decision rather than an accident. They arrived at `dist/archive/logo/`, which is build output and is gitignored, so keeping them meant moving them somewhere the repository keeps.

2.4.3 The notes on the sheet, and what each one costs

Every row's left column is the sheet's own wording. The right column is what it means once the mark has to live in a browser tab, on a phone masthead and in this document.

Table 17: The sheet's specification, and the issue against each

As the sheet states it	What it costs, and what was done
Golden Ratio 1 : 1.618	Adopted as drawn — the artwork <i>is</i> the construction, so nothing has to be re-derived. The number only became a question when the mark was being rebuilt rather than used; see Section 2.4.6
Letter Proportion S : C = 1 : 1.618	As above. Taken literally in a <i>rebuild</i> it makes the S fall to about the C's x-height; in Priscilla's own drawing the S is visibly larger than 1/1.618 of the C, which is why the drawing reads and a literal reconstruction did not
Grid System based on Fibonacci Spiral & Golden Rectangle	Visible in the artwork as construction lines, and they are part of the drawing, not scaffolding to be cleaned off. They are also the first thing to disappear as the file gets smaller — by 32 px they are grey haze (Figure 8)
Diagonal Hatching, Upper Left → Lower Right	The same direction and angle as the Leonardo hatch already running across the Tribute ground (<code>base.css</code> , <code>.hatch</code>) — an agreement nobody arranged, and worth keeping
Subtle texture / Enhances depth and form / Not overpowering	True at the sizes the sheet is drawn for. At 32 px the hatching has become tone rather than texture, and at 16 px it is a smudge. Nothing in the build can fix that; it is stated instead (Section 2.4.4)
Primary (Sage Green) #969B7D	Was <code>--field</code> , exactly, until 20 September 2026. The wall is now a darker, less saturated cut of it — the prototype's lightness at 21 % less chroma — because it went from a margin to the whole page (Section 2.2.5). This value remains the brand's: the mark, the icons and print use it
Black (For Print / Digital) #24241F	Not adopted as a site colour. The site's ink and bar are #3A2B22, a warm brown the whole palette is solved against; a cool near-black beside sage reads as a second, colder identity. It is kept for print, where it is what the sheet says
Reversed (Dark Background)	The variation that would suit the masthead best — and it is a <i>different drawing</i> from the preferred one: solid letters, no construction lines. It is still not used, because it is supplied at about 110 px. What the masthead carries since 20 September 2026 is the same idea arrived at from the preferred option: the drawing reduced to one colour and traced (Section 2.4.5), set in cream on the bar. Reversed, from her own artwork

As the sheet states it	What it costs, and what was done
Monochrome (One Color)	Held in reserve for single-ink reproduction, where the hatching and the letter cannot be separated by lightness at all
Deep Green #737C61	Was --field-deep, exactly, and moved with it (Section 2.2.5); still the sheet's, and still what the mark is drawn against
Warm Ivory #E9E2D3	Not added. It was within one step of what was then --wash-blue #E9E3D6, and a fifth cream is a fifth cream. The reading grounds have since gone sage and the creams with them; the artwork's own paper measures #E4DCCC and is kept as it is
Clear Space & Minimum Size — 15 mm (Print)	The icon build uses the sheet's clear-space rule as its crop, at 5.5 % of the monogram's side. The minimum size is the sheet's for print; the screen equivalents are in Section 2.4.4, and they are smaller than 15 mm
Horizontal lockup / Vertical lockup	Both are on the sheet and neither is used yet. The site's masthead is its own lockup — the mark beside a wordmark already set in Fraunces — and the two supplied lockups set the name in a different face
"Art connects what we share"	A line, not a tagline in use. It is not on the site, and nothing here proposes putting it there
"Timeless / Art Gallery / Identity"	The sheet's own note on intent. Recorded, and it is the right description

2.4.4 The issues, one by one

Four of these are worth more than a table row. None is a reason not to use the artwork; all four are reasons to know what using it costs.

1 — There is no vector, and the raster is 1536 × 1024. That is the whole supply. The monogram occupies about 590 px of it, which is enough for a 180 px home-screen icon and a masthead mark at 2× on a phone, and is the ceiling. A business card, a 15 mm foil stamp or a gallery window would each want the original vector or a much larger scan. **Ask for the source file** — it exists somewhere, and it costs nothing to keep with the rest.

2 — A drawn mark does not survive 16 px. Figure 8 shows the same crop of the same file at each size that ships. At 180 px it is the drawing; at 32 px the construction lines have gone to haze and the hatching to tone; at 16 px what is left is a shape that reads as *a monogram* rather than as an S and a C. That is the size a browser tab uses on a standard display. The sheet's own answer to this is on the sheet — the **Monochrome** and **Reversed** variations (Figure 7), which are solid-lettered drawings without construction lines and would hold at 16 px. Switching the small sizes to one of them is a one-line change in `scripts/build-icons.py`; it is not made here, because the instruction was to use the preferred option as it is.

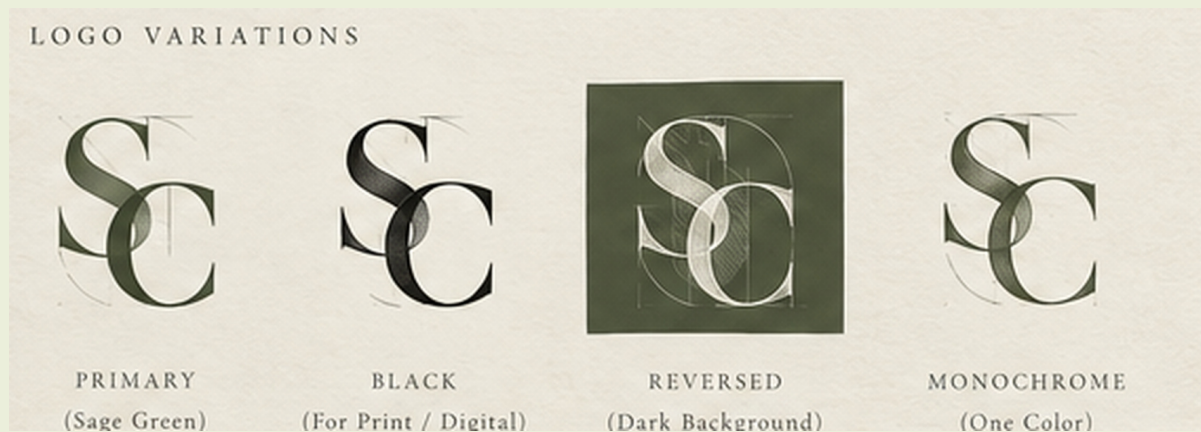


Figure 7: The variations panel, enlarged from Figure 5. These are a *different drawing* from the preferred option — solid letters, no construction lines — and they are what the sheet offers for the sizes and grounds the preferred one cannot hold.

3 — The mark is a photograph of paper, not a shape. It cannot take `currentColor`, cannot invert for a dark theme, cannot be recoloured for a seasonal card, and cannot be knocked out of a coloured ground. The site works with that rather than against it: the artwork is opaque cream, so on the dark masthead it arrived as a small mounted plate — a cream sheet on a dark ground, which is the site's central visual idea at wordmark size. **Since 20 September 2026 there is a shape too**, traced from the drawing for the surfaces that cannot hold a photograph; what that costs is Section 2.4.5. The masthead is now one of them, by decision the same day: the bar carries the vector, in the wordmark's own colour.

4 — The SVG favicon went away with it, and has come back. The site once shipped an `icon.svg`; a vector favicon is sharp at every size and is what a tab would rather have. It was dropped because there was no vector of this mark to ship, and an SVG wrapping a raster would be the same pixels behind a vector's promise. That is the one issue here now closed rather than stated: the tab is served a real shape again (Section 2.4.5), with the 32 px PNG, the `.ico`, the 180 px home-screen icon and the manifest behind it, all still cut from the artwork by the icon build.

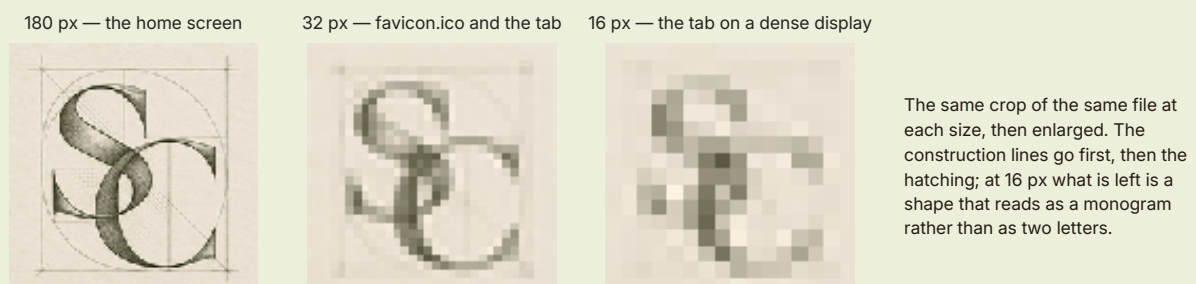


Figure 8: The adopted artwork at the three sizes the build cuts, each enlarged from the file that actually ships.

2.4.5 The mark, vectorized

Issues 3 and 4 above are one missing object. A mark that cannot take a colour cannot sit on a ground the site has not already decided, and a tab cannot be given a drawing; both want a **shape**. There is no vector source — open item 7 — so one was made from the artwork, and this section is what it costs, since a derivative that does not say what it is, is how a brand loses its own artwork.

Why a threshold does not do it. The letters in the drawing are not solid: they are built from hatching, at about a 3 px pitch in a 592 px monogram. At any single threshold a stroke therefore comes out striped, and morphology wide enough to close the stripes is also wide enough to close the counters. What *is* solid is the hatching's **density**, so the ink is blurred at a little over the hatch's own pitch first, and the letters are the region where that density stands above a level:

Table 18: The reduction, and what each number was solved against

Step	Value	Why that one
paper	the 85th percentile of <i>L</i>	The sheet, rather than the brightest pixel: a specular fleck would otherwise set the white point
blur	0.5 % of the crop's side	A shade over the hatch's pitch. Under it the stripes survive as ripples in the outline — at 0.34 % the trace needs eight more curves and leaves a notch in the S's counter, where the ribbon's lit side falls under the level. Far over it, the thin joins of the S melt into the counter
level	0.22 of the maximum	Where the C's left arm arrives whole without the construction lines arriving with it. By 0.34 the arm starts to break; under 0.18 the sheet's own construction circle is inside the letter
clean	close, then open, at 7 px	Closes what the hatch left open, then takes off the ticks and the paper grain. Pockets the hatching left <i>inside</i> a stroke are filled: they are not counters, they are places where the drawing is pale
trace	crack following, then Schneider	The boundary is walked on the pixel lattice with the ink kept on the left, smoothed out of its staircase by four 1–2–1 passes, simplified at 1 px, and fitted with cubics to 1.2 px

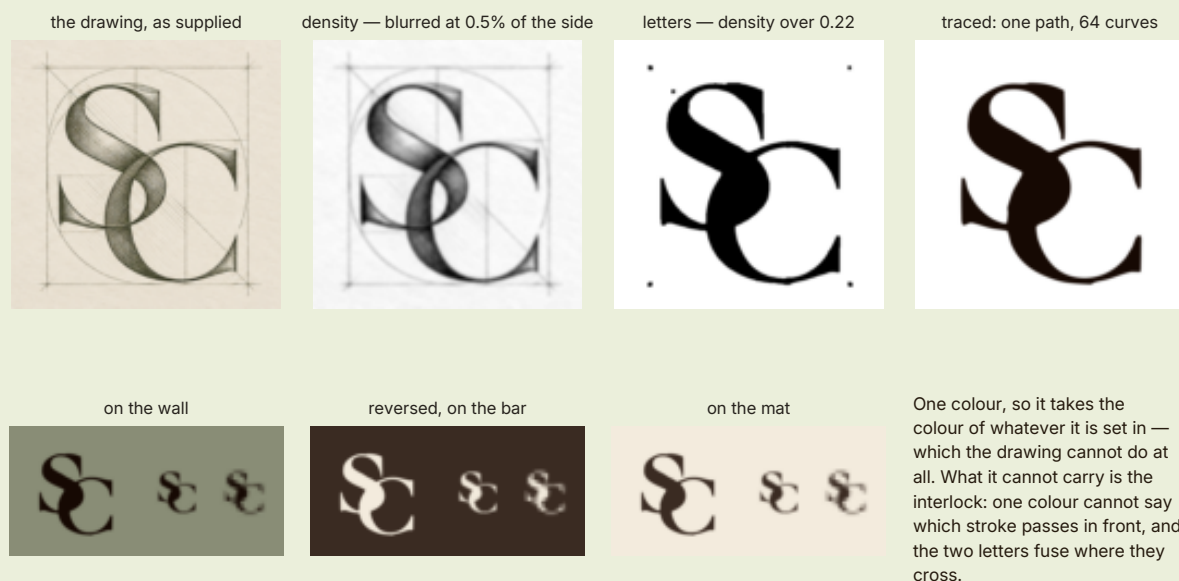


Figure 9: The reduction, stage by stage, and what it is for. Top: the drawing as supplied; its ink blurred at 0.5 % of the crop's side, which turns hatching into tone; the letters that stand above 0.22 of that tone's maximum; and the single path fitted to their boundary. Bottom: the same path on the wall, reversed on the bar and on the mat — it is one colour, so it is whatever colour it is set in — each with the 32 px and 16 px renderings enlarged beside it. Drawn by `docs/report/figures.py` from `scripts/build-mark-vector.py` itself, so the figure cannot describe a derivation the build does not perform.

The result is **one closed path, 64 curves, 2.9 KB**, and it is measured rather than admired: the builder renders its own output back to pixels and reports the intersection-over-union against the reduction it came from, which is **0.974**. `npm run check` re-runs the entire derivation and compares the committed file byte for byte, so the vector cannot quietly become something somebody edited by hand.

What the reduction cannot recover is which stroke passes in front. In the drawing the S crosses the C and is told apart from it by tone and by a drawn outline. One colour has neither, so the two letters fuse where they cross. Three ways to put the interlock back were tried and none survived being looked at: the light *valley* between the strokes cuts into the lit side of the S's own ribbon rather than between the letters; separating the dark cores never yields two components, because at every threshold that keeps the letters whole the strokes stay connected; and the drawing's own outline, which a ridge filter does recover, cuts cleanly in two places out of four, which reads as damage rather than as an interlock.

The sheet's answer to this is a **different drawing** — the Monochrome and Reversed variations (Figure 7), which resolve the overlap by hand — and they are supplied at about 110 px, which is not enough to trace. So the fused silhouette is what ships, and open item 7 gains its second reason: the vector source would settle the interlock as well as the resolution.

Where it is used, and where it is not. The tab, in both themes: `icon.svg` carries the site's `--bar` for a light tab strip and its `--paper` for a dark one, because a favicon has no page to inherit a colour from. Beside it, `mark-sc.svg` carries no colour at all — inlined in a page it is

whatever the text around it is, and handed to a printer it is a shape rather than a photograph of one.

And the **masthead**, which is the decision this section was written to leave open and which Priscilla took the same day. The bar used to carry the artwork itself, a cream plate of paper on the brown. What it could not do is take a colour: a photograph is the same photograph whatever it is set in, so the mark could not follow the bar, could not invert, and carried a cream rectangle into a place where nothing else on the site has an edge. The vector can — it is one path in `currentColor`, inlined rather than linked because `currentColor` is a cascade and an `<img>` has none, so the mark *is* the wordmark's colour and inherits every future change to it for nothing.

Three things went with that change, and each is the same sentence: it is made of ink now rather than of paper. The plate went — the radius and the mount shadow said “a cream sheet lies on the bar”, and there is no sheet. The size came down from 2.1 em to 1.7 em, because the drawing needed the extra size to hold its construction lines at 34 px and the traced shape has none. And the cream is `--paper` at 11.45:1 on the bar, which is the wordmark's own colour and the most legible pair on the site.

Four assertions, F-05: that the committed vector re-derives from the pinned artwork exactly, at an IoU of at least 0.95; that the inlinable copy names no colour at all while the tab copy names the site's own two; that the SVG icon is offered first with the raster set behind it, identically in both locales; and that both files are stamped with the source and its hash, that nothing is written back into `brand/`, and that this section still states what the reduction costs.

2.4.6 What was built before the artwork arrived

This is kept on the record, not as a second live logo. Between the decision to use a monogram and the arrival of the drawing, the site carried an `SC` **constructed** from Fraunces — the face the wordmark is already set in — with the outlines cut from the font at `opsize 40`, `wght 700` by `scripts/build-mark-paths.py`. `scripts/mark.mjs` still holds it, and the build asserts that nothing the *site* builds imports it: it exists so that Figure 10 can be drawn, and for no other reason.

Two things it settled are still worth having.

The first is a **proportion**. Drawn at the sheet's literal 1 : 1.618 in a square field, Fraunces' S falls to about the C's x-height and stops reading as a capital — the mark reads `sC` — and the C's lower arm cannot reach far enough left to close the hole the small S leaves. The construction used 1 : $\sqrt{\varphi}$ = 1 : 1.272 instead, the same construction one step in. It is not a correction to the sheet: measured off Priscilla's own drawing, her S is nearer 1 : 1.3 of her C than 1 : 1.618, so what the reconstruction found was that the *stated* ratio and the *drawn* ratio are not the same number. The drawn one is the one that reads.

The second is the **size rule**: hatching comes off below about 96 px, because below that it fills in. The construction could obey it, by simply not drawing the hatch at small sizes. The artwork cannot, because the hatching is in the pixels — which is issue 2 above, arrived at twice from opposite directions.

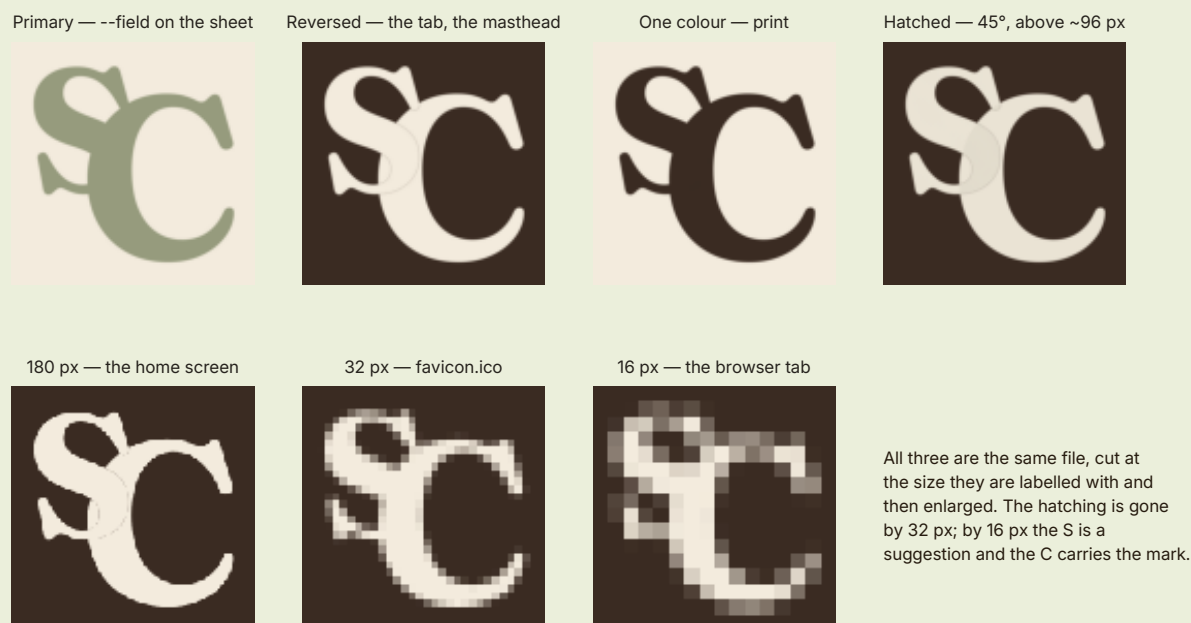


Figure 10: The interim construction: an SC cut from Fraunces outlines, in the four renderings the sheet's variation set asks for, and at the three sizes that decide whether a mark works. Superseded by the artwork; kept because the size argument survived it.

2.4.7 What it deliberately does not do

- **It spends no accent.** Sanguine is reserved for calls to action. Nothing in the artwork is sanguine, and nothing has been tinted to make it so.
- **It has no per-locale variant,** by construction, for the reason in Section 2.4.1: the same file, byte for byte, on both homepages.
- **It contributes no accessible name.** In the masthead the mark is an `<img>` with an *empty alt* inside the wordmark link, so the link's name is the gallery's name and nothing else — 2.5.3 Label in Name, and 2.4.4.
- **It is not cleaned up.** No tracing, no background removal, no contrast boost, no redrawing of the construction lines. `scripts/build-icons.py` is asserted to do nothing but crop, resize and save. The vector in Section 2.4.5 does trace — that is what it is for — but it is a second, declared object beside the artwork rather than a tidied version of it: the original is untouched, still pinned by hash, and still what the masthead and every raster icon are cut from.

2.4.8 Where it is used

The icon set — `icon-32.png`, `favicon.ico`, the 180 px home-screen icon and the manifest; `logo-mark.png` in the masthead, where the mark and the name are a single link and a single tab stop; and this document, in the footer of every page — all from `brand/mark-lockup.png`, by one crop, except the masthead, which since 20 September 2026 carries the vector instead. From the same crop by way of the reduction in Section 2.4.5: `icon.svg`, which the tab is offered first, `mark-sc.svg`, which carries no

colour and is there for anything that has to supply its own, and the path inlined into the bar.

The sheet's **horizontal lockup** was tried on this document's title page and taken off again, which is worth recording because it puts a number on open item 7. The lockup is **279 px** wide in the supply. At the 52 mm a title page wants it, that is **136 dpi**, and its wordmark's capitals are about 2 mm tall — type at 136 dpi is visibly soft in print, and this report is going to be printed properly. The monogram survives the same test easily (256 px at 8.8 mm is 738 dpi) and Fraunces is an outline at any size, so the title page carries the monogram with the name set beside it, exactly as the site's masthead does. Nothing about that is a preference; it is the resolution ceiling, met.

Thirteen assertions in `scripts/check-review.mjs` (F-01 to F-05) hold it together: that both originals are present and byte-for-byte the files that were supplied; that every derivative is a crop and a resize of the lockup and of nothing else, with no drawing, tracing or recolouring in the builder; that the masthead carries the artwork at a declared size and mounted as a plate; that the mark takes no accessible name of its own and is identical in both locales; that nothing the site builds redraws it; that the costs in Section 2.4.4 are still stated rather than quietly absorbed; and that this section still quotes the sheet's own values rather than paraphrasing them; and that the vector re-derives from the artwork exactly, names no colour of its own, and says in its own file what it came from.

2.5 Softness

The site as first built was correct and a little hard: square sheet, flat works, a colour swap for a hover and hard stops where sections met. This pass asked for something softer and more elegant — without making it less professional, and without changing a single colour.

Those two constraints do most of the design work. Every familiar softening technique reaches for new colour (a white card, a black shadow, a coloured glow) or for lower contrast (translucency), and this site has already argued, with measurements, against both.

2.5.1 What limits it

Three commitments made earlier in this document bound what “soft” may mean here.

- **Quietness is bought with size and whitespace, never with contrast.** Anything translucent puts text over a ground that is no longer a token, so its contrast has to be measured against the worst thing that can pass beneath it — which, on a site of paintings, is white.
- **Edges dissolve rather than rule** (Section 2.6). A softer site should have *fewer* lines, not decorative new ones.
- **A painting is never altered.** Rounding its corner crops it. Zooming it on hover implies it was cropped to fit. Stretching it misrepresents the object for sale.

Motion has its own limit, already recorded in the stylesheet: many viewport-heights of large images make scroll-triggered movement a vestibular risk, and every animation must stand down when the reader has asked for reduced motion.

2.5.2 Research notes

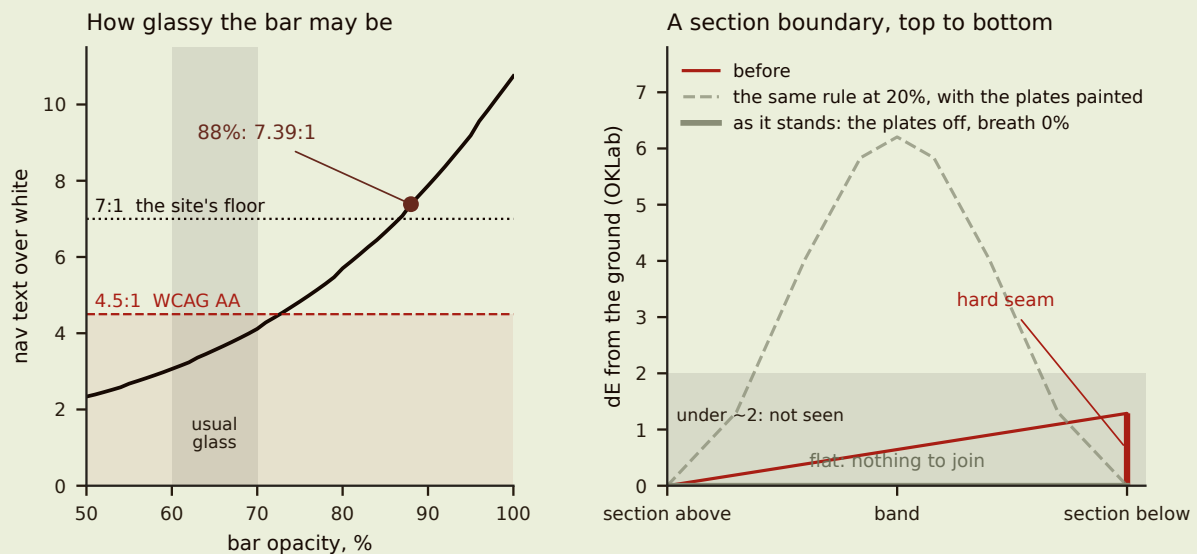


Figure 11: Left: how translucent the masthead may be, measured as navigation text over a white passage of a painting. Right: the lightness of a section boundary from top to bottom, before and after — and, dashed, the profile the same rule draws when the plates are painted, since with them off (Section 2.2.3) a boundary is flat. Both panels are computed from the live token file.

Glass has a hard floor, and it is high. The usual glassmorphism panel runs at 60–70% opacity. Over a white passage that puts the navigation at 3.06–4.11:1: a failure at caption size. WCAG's 4.5:1 is reached at 73%; a full AAA margin of 7:1 needs 87%. The glass that is legal here is subtle by necessity, and the right-hand side of Figure 11 is why it is still worth having: a painting passing under a solid bar is cut off by a slab, while under 88% it is *felt* as a soft blur of its own colour.

Glass at rest would repaint the brand. Prototyping showed a problem no contrast figure reveals: a translucent bar at the top of the page sits over the sage, so every page would show a greyed, greenish masthead instead of Priscilla's brown. Glass is only wanted once there is something beneath it.

A boundary between near-identical washes is invisible and hard at once. The washes differ by ΔE 0.8–2.6 in OKLab — at or under the threshold of perception when spread across 9 rem — so a boundary is only ever seen where it breaks: a band that fades to the wrong neighbour, or a section with no band at all, leaves a hard step that reads as a faint line. A band must fade between the grounds actually either side of it, and be visible enough to be felt.

A peak reads as a crease. A boundary that rises and falls through a few evenly weighted stops draws a pointed profile, and the eye finds the point. The adopted band follows a raised cosine across nine stops, which is what the right-hand panel of Figure 11 plots — read back out of the stylesheet rather than redrawn. The nine stops are still in the rule; the curve is drawn dashed there because `--edge-breath` is currently 0% (Section 2.2.3) and the band it draws is flat.

Motion on this site must settle, not perform. The motion tokens already say *leave quickly, settle slowly, never overshoot*. Cross-document view transitions let a painting carry from

the list into its own page. They need a unique name per element on each page; two elements sharing a name abort the whole transition, which rules out naming the lightbox copy.

2.5.3 Options

Every option considered is listed. **Adopted** items are built. **Optional** items remain available for a later pass, and where one fails a measured limit the reason says so.

Table 19: Softness options, by area

Area	Option	Status	Why
Edges	2 px on controls and panels, 3 px on the sheet	Adopted	Softens the pixel-hard corner without changing shape; a mount board is square
Edges	8–16 px radii	Optional	Reads as an app, not a gallery
Edges	Rounded corners on the paintings	Optional — <i>crops the work</i>	Rounding a corner removes part of the object being sold
Elevation	Three-layer shadows tinted with --bar	Adopted	A brown shadow sits <i>in</i> the paper; a black one sits on it and reads grey
Elevation	Single large neutral shadow	Optional	Reads as a glow
Margins	Passe-partout: a --paper-deep mat, no outline	Adopted	What a gallery does to a work; defined by tone and shadow, not a line
Margins	--paper mat with a hairline	Optional	Crisper and more card-like, but adds the line the site avoids
Margins	Shadow only, no mat	Optional	Softer still; loses the mounted look
Margins	Sheet floating from 900 px, not 1320 px	Adopted	On a 1280 px laptop the sheet used to run into the bar
Glass	Masthead at 88%, scroll-driven, desktop	Adopted	7.39:1 over white; solid at rest; nothing passes under it on a phone
Glass	Masthead at 60–70%	Optional — <i>fails 4.5:1</i>	3.06–4.11:1 over a white passage
Glass	Translucent reading panels over the sage	Optional — <i>unbounded contrast</i>	The sheet is the reading surface; text on glass over a painting has no worst case to solve against

Area	Option	Status	Why
Glass	Footer at 88% over the field	Adopted (18 Sep)	Behind it is the sage, not a painting, so the worst case is one computable colour: 9.13:1
Glass	Frosted plates on the sheet, at 72%	Adopted (18 Sep)	Cream over cream: the composite is always lighter than the wash beneath, so it cannot make any text worse
Field	A fall from a lifted --field to --field-deep	Adopted (18 Sep)	The largest solid on the site, and the only surface with nothing happening in it. Carries no text at any width
Boundaries	The field breathing through each band at 20%	Adopted	ΔE 5.3: plainly there when scrolling, a fifth of the way to the sage
Boundaries	Bands named by, and fading between, their actual neighbours	Adopted	No hard step where a band meets the section beside it
Boundaries	Each section its own sheet, with sage between	Optional	The most emphatic; replaces one mounted sheet with several and doubles the shadows
Boundaries	The mark set small at the centre of a band	Optional	A signpost that repeats the logo on every scroll
Boundaries	A hairline or short sanguine rule	Optional — <i>adds a line and spends the accent</i>	Contradicts both principles above
Motion	Nav underline drawn in from the left	Adopted	A transform, so nothing reflows and the 48 px target is unchanged
Motion	One-pixel button lift, pointer devices only	Adopted	On touch, :hover sticks after a tap
Motion	Mount shadow deepens when a work is hovered	Adopted	Elevation without touching the painting
Motion	Lightbox fades and settles 8 px	Adopted	No scale: a painting drawn at 99.5% is drawn wrong
Motion	Zoom a painting on hover	Optional — <i>alters the work</i>	Implies cropping; no hover on touch
Motion	Scroll-triggered reveals, parallax	Optional — <i>vestibular risk</i>	Also invisible in a link-card thumbnail and the first frame
Motion	Animated focus ring	Optional — <i>not recommended</i>	A focus indicator must be present the instant focus arrives

Area	Option	Status	Why
Navigation	Masthead held still across page changes	Adopted	Without it the whole bar dissolves and re-forms, which reads as a reload
Navigation	The painting carried from list to page	Adopted	Chromium and Safari; elsewhere navigation is simply instant
Navigation	Smooth scrolling for in-page jumps	Optional	A long glide past many large images; already declined

2.5.4 What was built

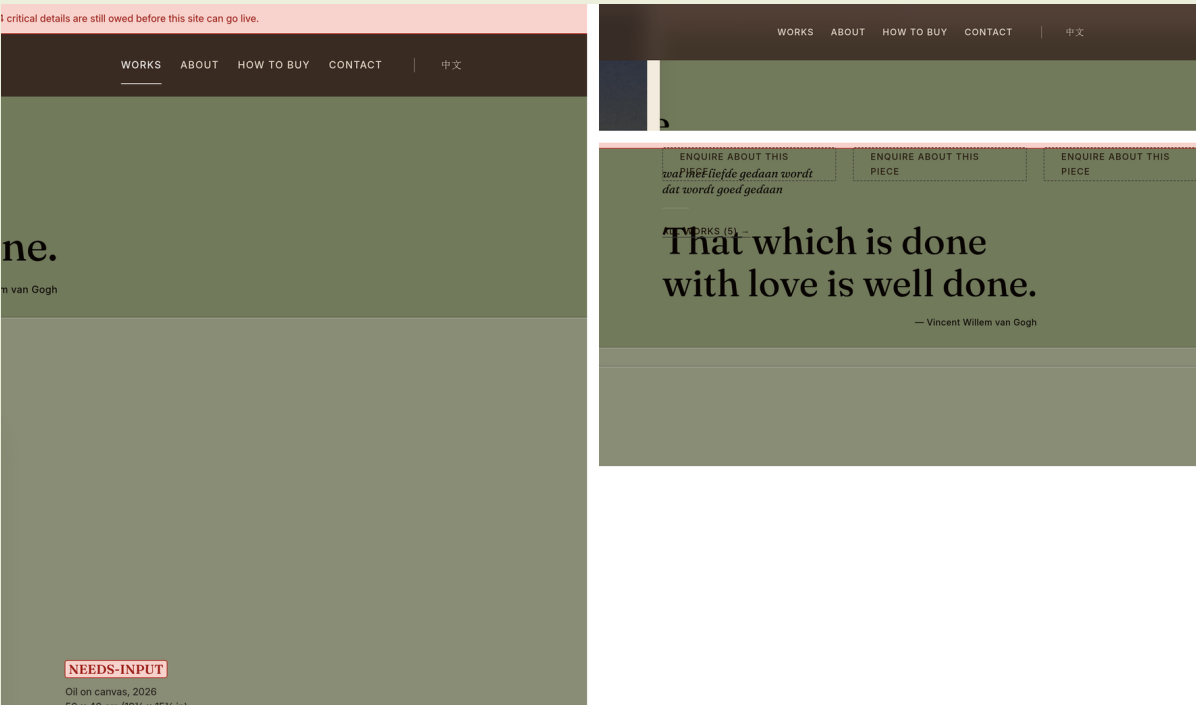


Figure 12: The adopted treatment, with a synthetic stand-in canvas in place of photography that does not exist yet. Left: hover — the navigation underline drawn, the mount lifted, the button raised one pixel. Top right: the glass bar at its scrolled state, with the canvas’s near-white highlight beneath it. Bottom right: the home-page boundary between Latest works and Series, which with the plates off (Section 2.2.3) is now flat sage: the mat, the shadows and the glass are what the pass left behind, and the band is what it took away.

Nothing in the palette changed. Every softness token — two radii, three shadows, the mat, the glass values and the boundary breath — is expressed through colours that already existed, and a check fails the build if a literal colour appears among them.

2.5.5 The glass, extended

A second pass on 18 September took the same treatment to the three surfaces the first one left flat, on the same terms: **nothing is translucent over a ground whose colour cannot be named.**

- **The field.** The sage ran as one fill from edge to edge — the largest solid on the site. It keeps its colour and gains a slow fall from a lifted `--field` at the top to `--field-deep` at the foot, fixed rather than scrolling, so the sheet reads as mounted on a ground that is lit. Both ends are palette values, and no text sits on the field at any width, so none of it is a contrast question.
- **The footer.** It runs the bar's own glass at 88%. Where the masthead's worst case has to be *assumed* — a painting can put pure white under it — the footer's is a single computable colour, because what is behind it is the field. That composite is written down as `--glass-footer #43372C`, and `check-contrast.mjs` recomputes it from `--bar`, `--glass-bar-opacity` and `--field` on every run and fails on any drift. Footer text measures **9.13:1** on it, and the contact details EU and Chinese law require to be published are the text in question.
- **Plates on the sheet.** The contact panel is now a frosted plate rather than a second ground stamped on the first. The safety argument is arithmetic: `--wash-lift` is lighter than every reading ground, so 72% of it over `--wash-deep` — the darkest of the three — composites to `#EBEFDD`, *lighter* than `--wash-deep`. A plate can only make the ground under text paler than the one already solved against, never darker. Since the plates came off the ground beneath it is the field (Section 2.2.3), and the same arithmetic now works the other way round: the panel is the one surface on the site that lifts its text back over 4.5:1.

So that a rule can say what it is really read on, a stylesheet rule may now declare a `--contrast-ground`. The check prefers it over whatever background the rule also paints, which is how a surface painted in a `color-mix()` the script cannot composite still gets solved against a real colour. The footer, the legal declaration and the channel row all declare one.

2.5.6 The line that says a section ended

The sfumato bands were built to dissolve a boundary rather than rule it, and they do — while there is something either side to dissolve. With the plates off there is not: a band joins the wall to the wall, `--edge-breath` is 0, and all four paint nothing at all (Section 2.2.3). What that left was nine rem of spacing between sections and a page that read as one long scroll.

So a boundary is now **stated**: an engraved hairline at the centre of each band — one line of shade with one line of light caught under it, 2 px in all. It is the pair an emboss is made of, and it is not a colour: black and white at low alpha, so the same two tokens work over the wall, over the About panel and over anything either of them is later changed to. The About panel's outline is the same pair, which is the point of there being only two — the page has one idea of what an edge is rather than a hairline here and a border there.

It is drawn on a pseudo-element rather than folded into the gradient, so the two mechanisms stay independent: restore the plates and `--edge-breath` and the sfumato returns

underneath the line, not instead of it. N-02 asserts that both — the boundaries and the panel — are drawn from that one pair, and that nothing else in the stylesheet uses it.

2.5.7 The canvas

The brief for this pass was the texture in the artwork, and not one colour with it. So the texture was **measured off the artwork** rather than chosen: a 300 px patch of blank ground in `brand/mark-lockup.png` has a mean of `#E4DCCC` and a luminance standard deviation of **4.87 of 255**, about 2.2 %, and its spatial spectrum falls off as $1/f$ with no periodic peak. That last detail settles what it is. A woven canvas has a weave, and a weave shows as a peak; this is a **cold-press cotton-rag sheet** — paper fibre, not cloth. What the tile ended up on is a mat board, which is the same material by another name.

One tile in `tokens.css` reproduces it: `feTurbulence`, desaturated, its output compressed to a narrow band about 0.5, tiled at 400 px. Getting the *character* right took as much measuring as getting the amplitude right — the first tile matched σ almost exactly and still read as a fine woven mesh rather than as paper, because a high octave count on an anisotropic base frequency makes `feTurbulence`'s own lattice visible. Six candidates were rendered beside a 1:1 crop of the artwork and compared; what the paper has is broad, cloudy low-frequency mottle with a faint tooth over it, which is a low base frequency and many octaves. Measured back out of Chrome on the built page, the field reads at σ **4.77** against the artwork's 4.87.

Why it cannot change a colour, and why that needed measuring

The tile is neutral grey with a mean of exactly 0.5, and it is composited in `soft-light`. Soft-light with a 0.5 source is the **identity** — $B(C_b, 0.5) = C_b$ — so the mean of a textured surface is the token it was painted with, and the grain only modulates around it. Measured, the largest mean drift on any ground is **0.9 of 255**, or 0.35 %.

That is true only because the filter declares `color-interpolation-filters="sRGB"`. Without it SVG filters run in `linearRGB`, `feTurbulence`'s 0.5 mean arrives as **0.73** in `sRGB`, and the tile that was supposed to be an identity lightens everything it touches. The first render did exactly that, and it was caught by measuring the result rather than by reading the specification — which is the same lesson as Section 2.2.7, in a different currency.

Where it may go was decided twice, and the second answer is the short one: **one material**. The tile is on the mat around a painting and on nothing else.

It was on three things — the field, the bands between sections, and the mat — and both of the others came off on 20 September 2026, each for its own reason and neither of them a matter of taste.

The **field** came off because it is the largest surface on the site, which made the grain most of what you saw rather than something you found. Nothing was lost in colour: the tile is mean-neutral under `soft-light`, so the field was never anything but `--field` either way. The brief for it was one line — *revert the sage backgrounds to the uncanvassed version, as in the original prototype* — and that is what the field is now: her flat green, lit from a raised `--field` at the top to `--field-deep` at the foot.

The **bands** came off because the reason they had it turned out not to be true. A band carried the same tile at 30 % as a *dither*, on the assumption that a nine-rem fade in eight bits

must step visibly. Measured at 1× over the built page, with the intended ramp subtracted so that only the error remains:

Table 20: What the dither was actually doing to a section boundary

Band, 144 px tall	Row-mean residual	Peak excursion
with the tile at 30 %	0.195 of 255	3.69
without it	0.173 of 255	1.04

Banding is a *horizontal stripe*, so the row-mean residual is the thing that measures it — and it is **lower without the tile than with it**. The browser dithers the gradient itself; the tile was adding per-pixel noise and no smoothness. The band's whole range is 19 of 255 over 144 px, about 21 levels, so even an engine that does not dither steps one level at a time across seven rows.

What is left is a rule about material rather than about arithmetic, and that is a change worth naming. The arithmetic used to bind: `check-contrast.mjs` solves how far a mean-neutral grain could move each reading ground before its tightest pair fell through its floor, and on cream the answer was nearly nothing. On the sage grounds it is no longer the constraint

Table 21: How much texture each reading ground could take

Ground	The tightest pair on it	Room either side of 0.5	The tile needs
--wash-pale	--muted-ui at 9.38:1	±0.500	±0.250
--wash-mid	--muted-ui at 9.25:1	±0.500	±0.250
--wash-deep	--muted-ui at 9.15:1	±0.500	±0.250

— the palest reading ground could now carry the whole tile and be measurably fine. It does not get it, because it is a wall and not a board. The check still fails the build if any rule ever paints a reading ground *and* textures it, and `check-review.mjs` G-07 asserts the narrower rule by name: the textured selectors are the mat and the video's mat, and there are two of them.

This document is no longer printed on it. Every page of this report used to be --wash-warm carrying the same tile, on the argument that it was the site's own paper. The site's paper is untextured now, so the argument has expired: the report is printed on --wash-pale, flat. It also removes a 300 dpi image from underneath every page, which is one less thing between the press and the type.

The page you are holding therefore carries a colour the site itself no longer paints (Section 2.2.3), and keeps it deliberately. A screen is lit and a page is not; a printed page has no field behind it to show through, and every word of this document is a word that has to be read. --wash-pale is the lightest ground the project ever solved for prose, which is the right paper for a document whichever way the site's own switch is set.

2.5.8 How it is held

- `check-contrast.mjs` composites the bar at `--glass-bar-opacity` over pure white and fails the build below 7:1 for navigation text. Set to the usual 70%, it names three failures.
- `check-render.mjs` lays the built pages out in Chrome and asserts that every painting's box keeps the painting's own proportions to within 1%, with no radius and no transform (Section 5.4).
- Three more (G-07) cover the canvas: one tile, defined once and referenced exactly twice; the tile neutral, symmetric about 0.5, declared in sRGB and blended with soft-light; and the textured selectors exactly the two mats.
- Five more (L-01 to L-05) cover the decisions of 20 September 2026: the fifteen rules allowed to paint cream and no sixteenth; the three reading grounds all at the field's own hue and all above the lightness where `--muted-ui` fails; the italic a real file with synthesis off; About set as a book page in both languages, including the two refusals on the Chinese one; and every surface that is read painting a plate token, with no rule naming a wash directly, so that the plates stay reversible from the token file alone (Section 2.2.3).
- Six assertions in `check-review.mjs` (G-01 to G-06) cover the rest: no literal colour in the new tokens — with one named exception, `--glass-footer`, allowed only while the contrast check recomputes it — a mat and nothing that alters a painting, glass solid at rest and gated, all new motion standing down for reduced motion, one transition name per painting per page, and every band joining the grounds actually either side of it — by their plate tokens, so the join holds whatever those plates are painted.

2.6 The two masters

The brief asked for a debt to Leonardo and to van Gogh, carried without ever announcing itself. The test applied throughout: *a visitor who knows nothing should feel only that the site is calm and well made; a visitor who knows the work should feel recognised.*

2.6.1 What was adopted

- **The accent is sanguine.** Red chalk, the medium Leonardo drew in, measures 6.33:1 on white; the oxblood Priscilla chose by eye measures 6.68:1. They are the same colour. The recommendation was to change nothing and record why.
- **No hard edges.** Leonardo's instruction to paint "*without strokes or lines, in the manner of smoke*" and the Chinese 没骨 ("boneless") tradition of painting without contour are the same idea reached independently. For a Chinese painter addressing both audiences that is a structural principle, not a motif. Section boundaries dissolve rather than rule.
- **The rules are van Gogh's stated violet.** He told Theo the *Bedroom* walls were "of a pale violet"; they read blue today because the red lake faded. The site uses the colour he said, not the colour that survived.
- **Hatching runs his way.** Leonardo was left-handed, so his stroke runs upper-left to lower-right. No text source could be retrieved, so the 43.8° angle is an original structure-tensor measurement of his sheets, validated against a right-handed control.

2.6.2 What was cut, and why

The myth filter

Golden-ratio grid. Unsupported. Illustrating Pacioli's *De divina proportione* establishes that Leonardo drew the solids, not that he composed on the ratio.

"Leonardo invented sfumato", and the word itself. Cennino Cennini described blending shadows like smoke a century earlier, and Leonardo never used the noun — a full-text search of the *Trattato* returns none.

Any yellow as text. Indian yellow is 2.10:1 and zinc yellow 1.53:1. Both are genuine *Starry Night* pigments and both are unusable for anything but a mark inside an image.

Sampling colours off the paintings. The *Bedroom* wall as it survives today is 2.78:1; the *Sunflowers* chrome yellow 2.70:1. Both sit within a hair of the 2.67:1 failure this report opens with.

2.7 The site's structure

The first build's menu — *Original Works*, *Tribute*, *About*, *How to Buy* — mixed jumps down the homepage with real pages, had no page that listed the works, and could group a work only by a two-value field. None of that survives a catalogue growing past a few dozen works, or a new genre. The structure below replaced it.

2.7.1 Method

Six reference sites, chosen to cover the three models this site sits between: artists' own sites (David Hockney, Kehinde Wiley Studio), galleries (David Zwirner, Victoria Miro) and marketplaces for original work (Saatchi Art, Artfinder). Each was **rendered in headless Chrome**, not fetched as HTML: two of the six build their navigation and filters with scripts, and a plain fetch reported Saatchi as having no filters at all. Navigation, hierarchy, breadcrumbs and side columns were read from the rendered page and checked against a screenshot. Three first choices could not be used: Gerhard Richter's site was offline, Hauser & Wirth rate-limited the request, and Artsy refused it.

Counting `<aside>` elements suggested four of the six had sidebars; every one was a region-settings pop-up, so only the rendered layout was trusted.

2.7.2 What the six agree on

Columns: **H** Hockney · **W** Kehinde Wiley · **Z** David Zwirner · **VM** Victoria Miro · **S** Saatchi Art · **A** Artfinder.

Table 22: The six reference sites, September 2026

Pattern	H	W	Z	VM	S	A	Majority
Works under one entry; no series beside About	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	6 / 6
Buying reachable from the header	—	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	5 / 6
Contact reachable from the header	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	—	4 / 6
A navigation sidebar	—	—	—	—	—	—	0 / 6
Highlights or latest in a sidebar	—	—	—	—	—	—	0 / 6
A filter sidebar	—	—	—	—	✓	✓	2 / 6
Breadcrumbs	✓	—	—	—	✓	✓	3 / 6
<i>How to buy</i> as a header page	—	—	—	—	—	—	0 / 6

Two things the table does not show. The filter sidebars both belong to marketplaces listing tens of thousands of works — Artfinder's showed *60 of 25,000*. And where an artist's own site organises a large body of work, it does it one level down: Hockney's *Works* opens onto media, and within *Paintings* a horizontal row of decades.

2.7.3 The sidebar question

No. Not for navigation, highlights or anything latest.

- **None of the six uses one for navigation or highlights.**
- **Right-hand columns are not looked at.** Eye-tracking puts desktop attention on right-rail content at 0.8% of fixations: people have learned that the side column is where advertising lives, and avoid it whatever it holds.¹
- **Local navigation is for large sections.** It earns its space when visitors browse and compare many sibling pages, and is not needed for small ones; when it is used it should be less prominent than the global navigation.²
- **Filters belong beside the grid only when there are many of them.** Sidebar filters are often overlooked because they sit where navigation and banners usually are; a horizontal row above the results works for up to six to eight filter types, and a sidebar is the better choice beyond that.³

Where this site needs what a sidebar would carry, it gets it in the reading path instead: the *latest* works are a homepage section, each series is a room with its own page, and the Works section's rooms are one quiet row of tabs.

2.7.4 What was built

- **The header goes to four real pages:** *Works*, *About*, *How to Buy*, *Contact* (作品, 关于, 购买方式, 联系), and marks the one the visitor is in — page on the section's own page, true beneath it.

¹Nielsen Norman Group, [Fight against "right-rail blindness" and Banner blindness revisited](#).

²Nielsen Norman Group, [Local navigation is a valuable orientation and wayfinding aid](#).

³Baymard Institute, [Be careful with horizontal filtering toolbars](#).

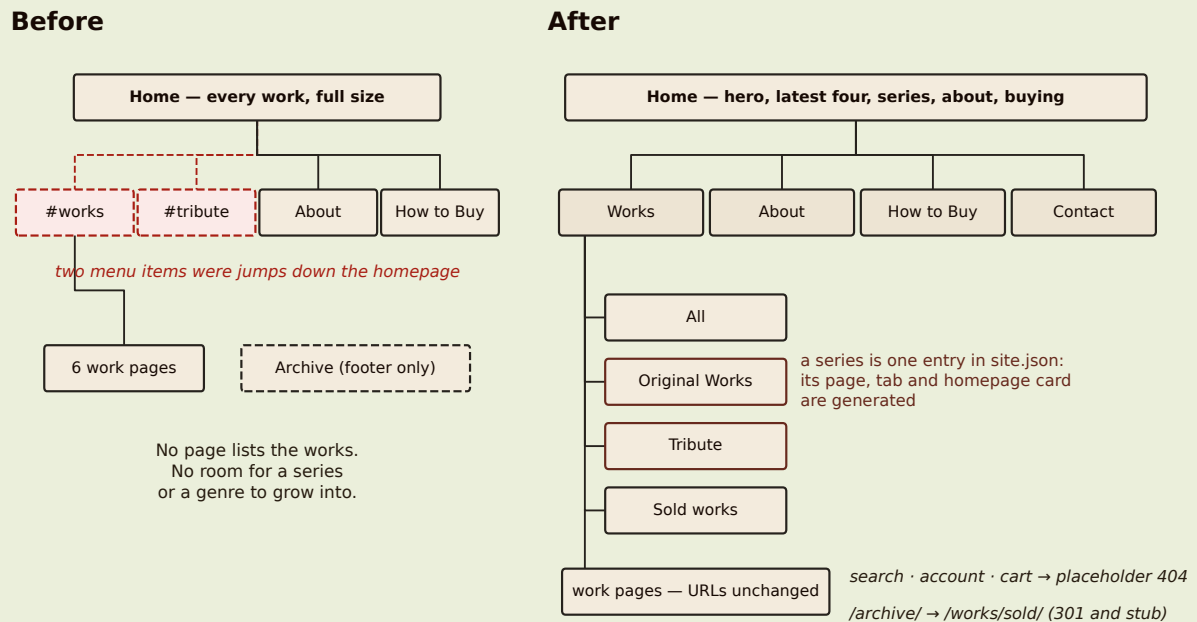


Figure 13: The site map before and after. The after tree is drawn from `site.json`, the same data the build generates the navigation and series from.

- **Works is the catalogue.** `/works/` lists every available work, newest first, with a row of tabs: *All*, *Original Works*, *Tribute*, *Sold works*, each with its count. Each series is a room at `/works/series/{id}/`; sold works moved from `/archive/` to `/works/sold/`.
- **Series are data.** A series is one entry in `site.json`; its page, its tab and its homepage card are generated from it, and the build refuses a work that names an undeclared series or genre, or a slug that would collide with a page under `/works/`.
- **The homepage is a front door, not the catalogue:** van Gogh's line — his Dutch above the reader's language — beside one *Featured work*, the four *Latest works* with a link to all of them and their number, a card for each series, About, and How to Buy.
- **Breadcrumbs from the second level down**, with the current page as text and a work's trail running through its one series (*Home / Works / Tribute / ...*), and published as structured data. The top level has none: there is nothing above it to return to.
- **The footer carries the channels as marks.** Instagram, Facebook, X, Bluesky, 小红书 and WeChat, drawn on one 24-unit grid at one stroke weight in the footer's own colour — a set that belongs to this site rather than six logo files that belong to six other companies. Each is a 48 px target with a visually hidden name, because an icon has no accessible name of its own. A handle turns its mark into the real profile link; WeChat and 小红书, which have no address derivable from a handle, go to the contact page where the handle is printed. **Until a channel has its handle its mark still appears and links to a route that does not exist**, so the click lands on the 404 page — the same arrangement decision D1 used for search, account and cart while those three had controls, and policed the same way: the route must be declared in `site.placeholders.social`, and must still be dead. Readiness rule ID-06 requires every channel to be a handle or an explicit "" before a release will build, which is what clears the placeholders by itself.
- **Nothing that was shared breaks.** Work pages keep their addresses. `/archive/` answers with a 301 on Cloudflare Pages and with a redirecting page on hosts that cannot send one.

2.7.5 The order of the four

The site has four places to go — *Works, About, How to Buy, Contact* — and Priscilla asked for them in that order, in the header and on the homepage. The header was already in it. The question worth answering was whether it is the right one, and what the homepage should do with it, so the sample from Section 2.7.1 was widened and read for **order** rather than for structure.

Table 23: What eight sites put first, and where they put Contact

Site	Header, in order	About	Contact
Gagosian	Exhibitions · Artists · Fairs & Collecting · Quarterly · News · Locations · Shop	—	footer
Pace	Artists · Exhibitions · Art Fairs · Events · Journal · Publishing · Galleries	secondary bar	footer
Victoria Miro	Artists · Exhibitions · Art Fairs · Channel · Store	—	footer
Kehinde Wiley	Exhibitions · Special Projects · Selected Works · About Contact · Press · Shop	4th	4th, with About
Tappan Collective	Collect · Artists · The Edits · Journal · Info · Gift Cards	under <i>Info</i>	footer
Singularart	New In · Painting · Prints · Photography · Sculpture · Drawing · Artists	footer	footer
UGallery	Shop Art · Our Artists · Commissions · About Us	4th	footer
Artfinder	the catalogue, by medium and by artist	footer	footer

Three things every one of them agrees on.

The work is first. Eight out of eight open with the catalogue under one name or another — *Exhibitions, Artists, Collect, Shop Art, New In*. Not one leads with the gallery’s own story.

Contact is last, or it is not in the header at all. Six of the eight keep it in the footer entirely; the two that surface it put it at the end. Nothing in the sample puts Contact before About.

Four to six items. The marketplaces run longer because their nav *is* the catalogue’s facets; the artists’ and galleries’ own sites sit at four to six. This site has four.

That settles the order by convention, and the **serial position effect** settles why it is the right one rather than merely the common one: in any list, the first and last items are the ones attended to and remembered, and the middle is where attention goes to die.⁴ The two that matter commercially here are the first — the work, which is the product — and

⁴The serial-position effect: first and last items in a list are recalled best, the middle worst — Ebbinghaus’s finding, summarised for interface work by *Laws of UX* and applied to navigation order by *CXL* and *Con-vertize*. Nav orders in Table 23 were read from each site’s rendered header in September 2026.

the last — Contact, which on a site with no cart is the checkout. About and How to Buy are the reasons to act, and they belong between the two.

Where this site departs from the sample, it does so knowingly, and both departures come from the same fact: **there is no cart, and the border is in the way.**

- **How to Buy is in the header.** Five of the eight keep buying help in the footer, behind an FAQ. Here, how buying works is a question the visitor has *before* they choose anything — payment is arranged by message, duty is the buyer's to anticipate, and the returns window is a promise that has to be found. The threshold for moving it to the footer is already written down (Table 24): when the cart takes payments.
- **About is in the header.** The galleries push their own story into the footer because the artists are the product. Here the artist *is* the product: the pledge, the slowness and the reason there are not many works are what a buyer is buying into.

The homepage now runs in the same order, and ends where the header ends. It used to stop at *How to Buy*: it explained how buying works and handed the reader to the footer, which is where a legal address lives rather than where an invitation does. A **Contact close** was added — the section's own intro and one quiet link, with the details left in the one place they already live — so the last thing on the page is how to reach the person who painted it.

One link came off in the same pass. The band under the masthead carried a *View works* link out of the hero with it (Section 2.7.7); the header's first item already goes there and the Latest works section ends with the same link, so a third route to one page, inside the page's own statement, was a link asking to be counted rather than used. The band is the quote and the palette now, and nothing else. I-07 asserts the header's order and the page's, in both languages.

2.7.6 Where it stays personal

The consensus decides the shape; the site keeps its own character inside it.

- **Tribute keeps its room.** The van Gogh epigraph and the hatch texture that marked its homepage section now mark its series page — the room it belongs in — and it has a card of its own on the homepage.
- **The front door keeps the gallery's voice:** the motto in two languages and one painting, and the sfumato bands between sections, each still joining the grounds either side of it.
- **One departure from the six.** None of them puts *How to Buy* in the header, and here it stays there. The six either take cards through an ordinary checkout or sell to collectors who expect to enquire. This site sells across a border, without cards, with import duty the buyer has to anticipate, and with its cart still a placeholder; how buying works is a question a visitor has before they have chosen anything. When the cart works, *How to Buy* moves to the footer and the cart becomes the header's way in to buying — as five of the six have it.

2.7.7 The band under the bar

The gallery's own line — van Gogh's *wat met liefde gedaan wordt dat wordt goed gedaan*, and its translation — used to stand in the hero's left column beside the featured painting, with *View works* under it. Six words and a link holding a column open next to an object is the arrangement finding A-01 was about in the first place, one step further on: a quote that is the gallery's statement is not a sibling of a work, it is the top of the page.

It is now a **band**, full width, immediately under the masthead, held open by its padding and closed by an engraved line. The hero below carries nothing but the painting.

It is **painted in the About panel's dark sage**, #727A5C. It was the bare wall, which made it a stretch of page with a quotation lying on it rather than a band, and left the boundary at its foot ruling one green off from the same green. Now the two places this site speaks in the first person — the gallery's own line, and the artist's own — share a ground.

That ground is the exact centre of the mid-tone squeeze (Section 2.2.6): pure black measures 4.65:1 on it and pure white 4.52, so the whole palette has about 3% of headroom and --ink-deep is the only token that clears 4.5. The Dutch, the translation and the attribution were --body, --ink and --muted, which measure 3.73, 4.33 and 3.50 on this green — all three under the floor — and are now that one ink, exactly as everything in the About panel is. The hairline between his words and their translation went with them: --rule-soft is solved for the wall at 1.36:1 and measures 1.79 here, which is a line you read rather than one you feel, so the band draws it in the wall's own colour, 1.34 on this green. check-contrast solves the panel as a ground, so a fourth colour cannot arrive here unmeasured.

Three things had to be measured rather than chosen.

The fold. A band that pushes the painting off the opening screen would undo A-01 with better manners. At 1440 × 900 the masthead is 110 px, the band 330, the hero's own padding came down from 96 to 48, and the featured painting now starts at y = 600 in a release build — on screen, where the finding asked for it.

The shape of the quote. It was set in four short lines, so that the Dutch and the English stood in the same shape; in a wide band four short lines are a column, which is the thing the band exists to stop being. Both are now two lines, still the same shape as each other, and still set as written.

The size at every width. The motto may never be re-wrapped by the browser — the attribution is aligned to the real right edge of its longest line, and a browser cannot shrink a box to the longest line of wrapped text. So its size is decided by that line rather than by taste: *"with love is well done."* is 10.42 ems wide, which is 563 px at the ladder's 54 px ceiling inside a 1060 px column, and 271 px at its 26 px floor inside the 280 a 320 px screen gives.

It used to be 38.4 px with two step-downs, at 519 px and 359 px. It is now the `clamp()` of Section 2.3.6, which does the same job continuously and does it for every heading rather than for the motto alone. check-render measures the rendered line count against the `<br>`s at five widths either way, and fails the build on a re-wrap.

The band sits **between** `<header>` and `<main>` rather than inside either. Inside the header it would become the sticky bar's containing block, and the bar would stop sticking once the band scrolled past — which is the bar Section 2.5.5 measures. Inside `main` it would be inside the mounted sheet, and a band that stops at the mount's rounded corner is not a band. It carries no landmark of its own, so the page's landmark count is what it was.

Four decorative rules in the sheet's own brand colours ran across its foot until the second review took them out (Section 2.10). On sage they read as a progress bar or a palette chip, and the cream one as a stray highlight: the only unexplained ornament on a site whose argument is that nothing here is unexplained. `check-review N-01` used to hold them in place and now holds them out, of the markup and of the stylesheet both.

2.7.8 The artist's portrait

A site selling one painter's work had no photograph of the painter. About is the one part of it that is a person rather than a catalogue — the pledge, the reason there are not many works, the sentence about pausing in front of one — and it was set as an essay with nobody in it.

It is now framed in both the places About appears, and in both it sits at the **foot of the prose**, in the same column, like a sign-off.

Not at the head. About is about the work and the pledge rather than about the artist, and a portrait leading it would announce a different page from the one that follows — a biography, which this is not. At the end it is what it actually is: who wrote that. The onward links come after it, so the last thing in the column is the way out rather than a picture.

It is small for the same reason: 9 rem in the homepage section and 10.5 rem on the page, capped at the column's own width on a phone. A signature, not a plate. The About page could not have given it a column beside the text in any case — that page's mount is 660 px around a 34 rem measure, because finding D-01 brought it in to the column, and 660 less the 544 px the measure takes leaves 116 px, which is a margin.

It is mounted as a painting. The same cream mat, the same board grain, the same mount shadow, from the same rule: the stylesheet names `.portrait__img` alongside `.work__img`, so there is one mat on this site rather than two, and the artist's photograph is an object on a wall like everything else on it. What it does not take is everything that would make it a work — no zoom cursor, no lightbox, no view transition, no entry in the catalogue, no price. The caption under it is the artist's name, in the small caps a tombstone uses, in `--muted` at 4.62:1 on the wall; the About page sets its prose in the display face, and the caption keeps the interface face in both places, because a signature is not running text.

While there is no photograph the frame holds the image pipeline's own placeholder card, so the layout is real and can be judged at every width, and a release build leaves the frame out altogether rather than ship an empty mat. That is the arrangement rule WK-10 already uses for a work's unshot views, and it is what keeps this from becoming a permanent gap in the page: a site with no portrait is a site with no portrait, not a site with a hole in it.

Two rules hold the two halves of that. **ID-08** is a warning, not a blocker — a portrait is editorial, not legal, so nothing here can keep the site from going live — and it reports, in every readiness report, that the frame will be omitted. **ID-07** is a blocker that cannot be waived, and applies the moment the photograph is real: a photograph on a page has to be described (1.1.1), and nobody can describe one that has not been taken, so until then the rule `owns site.about.portrait.alt` and the general placeholder backstop leaves it alone. Supplying `masters/portrait.jpg` and running the image build is the whole of turning the frame on; the photograph keeps its own proportions, because the frame is built from the size the pipeline recorded.

Four assertions, M-01: that both places sign off with the frame, in both languages, after the prose and before the links; that it is matted like a painting, carries its own width and height so it costs no layout shift, and is in no way a work; that an empty frame is marked as a placeholder and is gated out of a release; and that the description rule is unwaivable, conditional and owns its own field.

2.7.9 How it grows

The depth is fixed at three levels below the homepage — *Works* / *series* / *work* — because more than a few levels is where visitors lose their way;⁵ growth is added across, not down.

Table 24: Growth rules

When	Then
A new series is added	One entry in <code>site.json</code> ; page, tab and card follow. Asserted (I-03)
Genres come into use: two or more among available works	A horizontal genre filter row on <code>/works/</code> . A genre is a filter, never a fourth level: a landscape in <i>Tribute</i> is in one room and matches two filters ⁶
The Works tabs pass eight, or filter types pass eight	The Works navigation moves to a left column on desktop — the one case the research supports a sidebar. The eight-tab ceiling is asserted today (I-06), so the change cannot happen by accident
More than six series	The homepage shows six series cards and a link to all
About gains pages — CV, exhibitions, press	About gets its own row of tabs, as Works has
The cart takes payments	<i>How to Buy</i> leaves the header for the footer

2.7.10 How it is held

Assertions I-01 to I-06: the header links to four real pages and marks the current one; every work is listed exactly once — on *Works*, on its series page, or among sold works; the homepage shows at most four and states how many there are; a series needs only data; deeper pages carry a breadcrumb whose last step is the page itself; the old address still arrives; and no navigation lives in a side column. The render check covers the catalogue, both series pages and sold works.

⁵Nielsen Norman Group, [Flat vs. deep website hierarchies](#).

⁶Nielsen Norman Group, [Polyhierarchies improve findability for ambiguous IA categories](#).

2.8 The site as built

Six captures of the preview build, five on a desktop and one on a phone. They are not mockups: `docs/report/shots.sh` takes them from `dist/` each time this document is built, so they show the site as it is. The ribbon across the top of each page and the red NEEDS-INPUT flags are the preview's; a release has neither (Section 5.5).

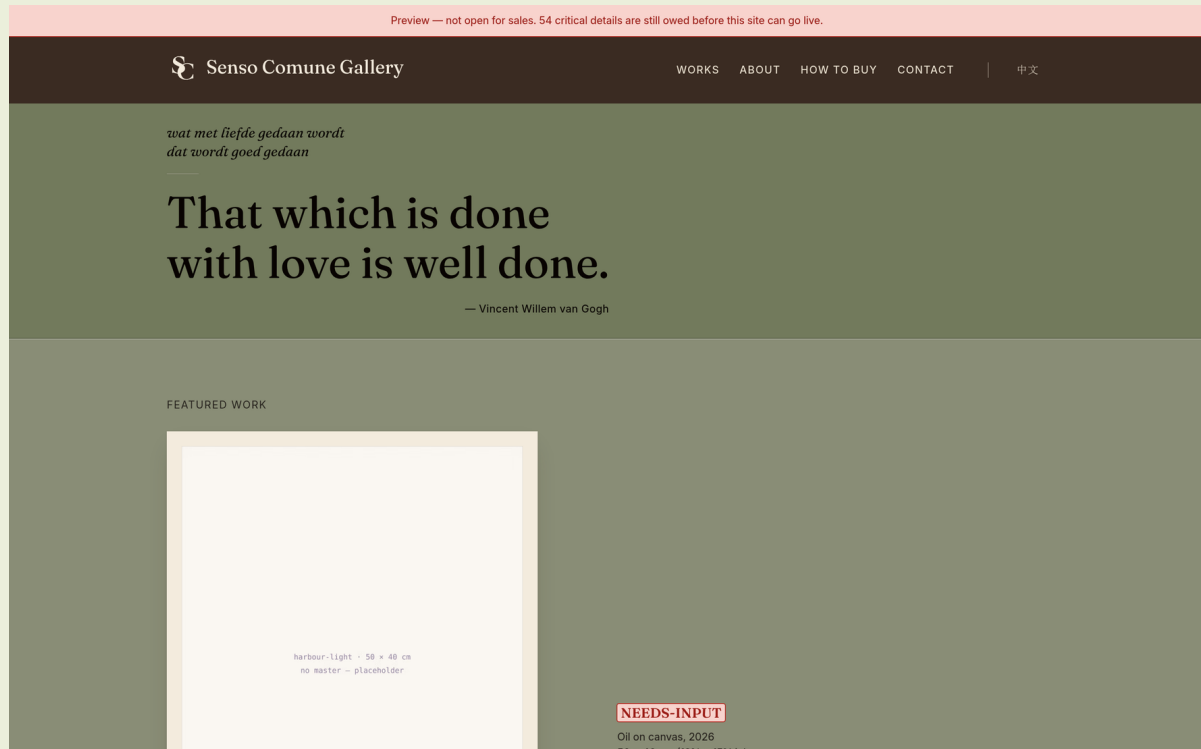


Figure 14: The homepage as it now stands, with the plates off (Section 2.2.3): one sage field from the bar to the footer, nothing painted under the content column, and cream kept for the mat around the work — which is what makes the work separate from the ground. Dark brown bar, the SC monogram at the head of the wordmark — the traced vector, in the wordmark's own cream (Section 2.4.5) — and, at the right, the language switch, which is the one control in the masthead that changes anything (Section 2.10). Under the bar, the band, painted in About's darker green: van Gogh's line stands twice, his Dutch from letter 143 to Theo — *wat met liefde gedaan wordt dat wordt goed gedaan* — set small and italic above the reader's own language, with his full name beneath, aligned to the quote's longest line (Section 2.7.7). The featured work follows below it, on a piece of wall of its own proportion with its label at its foot, and each section boundary is stated by an engraved line (Section 2.5.6).

2.9 The design review

The built site was reviewed in September as a designer rather than as its author. Nineteen findings, in five groups; eighteen were implemented, and each is held by an assertion of the same number in `check-review.mjs`.

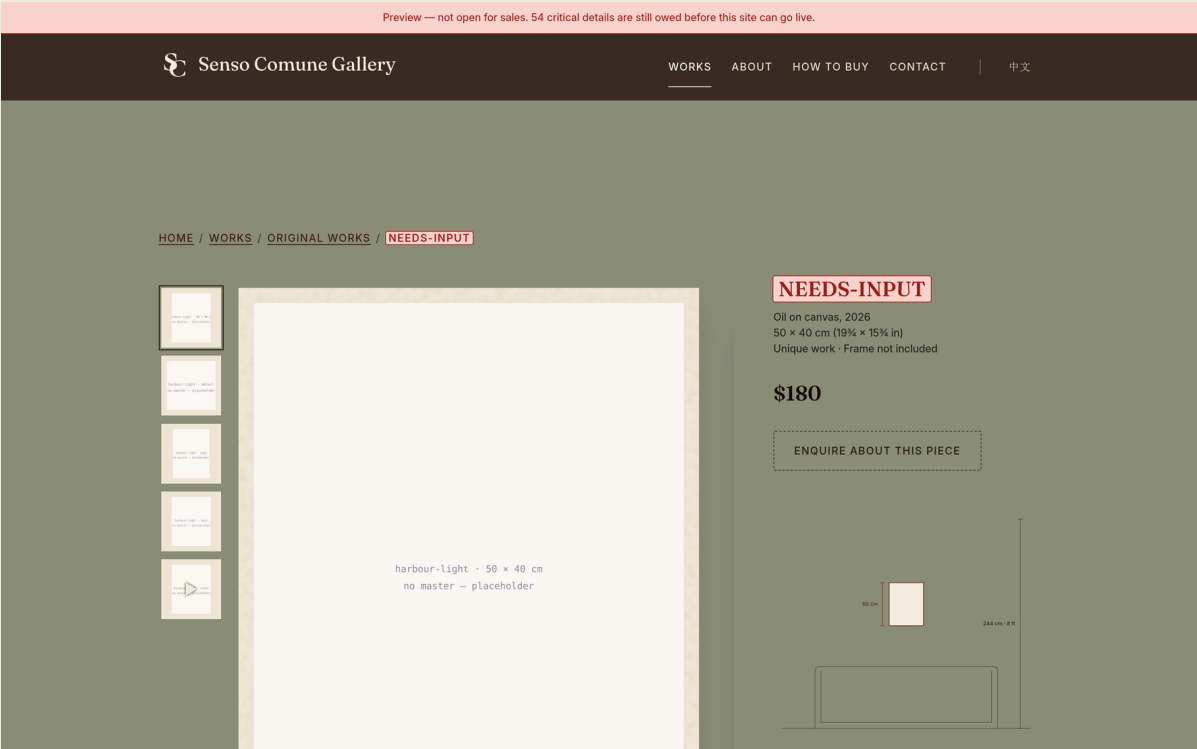


Figure 15: A work page. The views of the work — front, detail, edge, back and video — sit in a strip with thumbnails always visible, grey placeholders until the photographs exist. The price is the boldest element in the block. The scale diagram shows the painting against a 244 cm wall and a 213 cm sofa, hung at the museum standard of 144.78 cm, which is also where the mark’s datum sits.

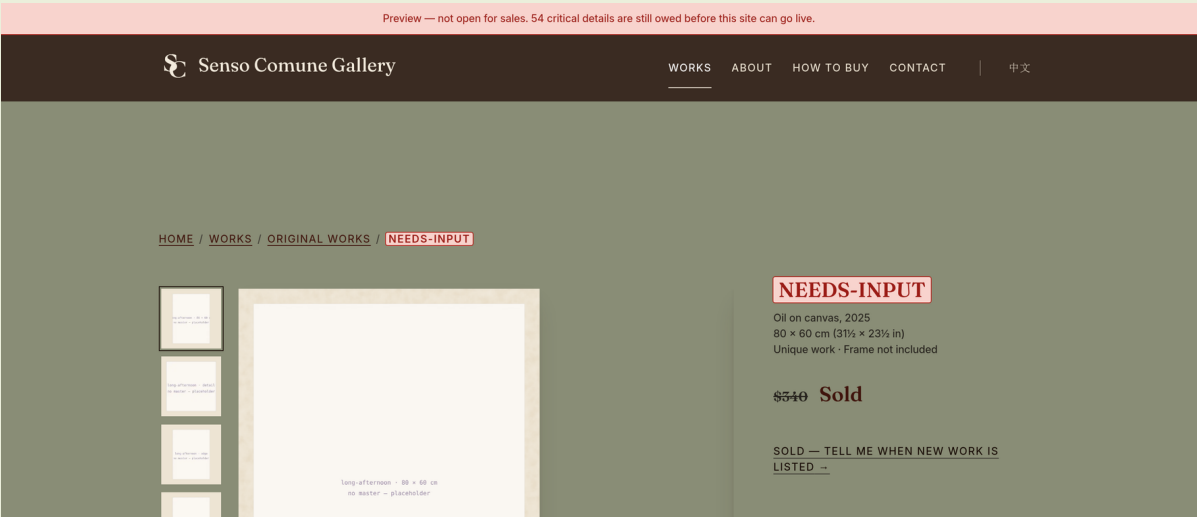


Figure 16: The sold state. The price stays visible as social proof, “Sold” sits at full contrast in the price position, and the call-to-action slot becomes a capture rather than a dead end.

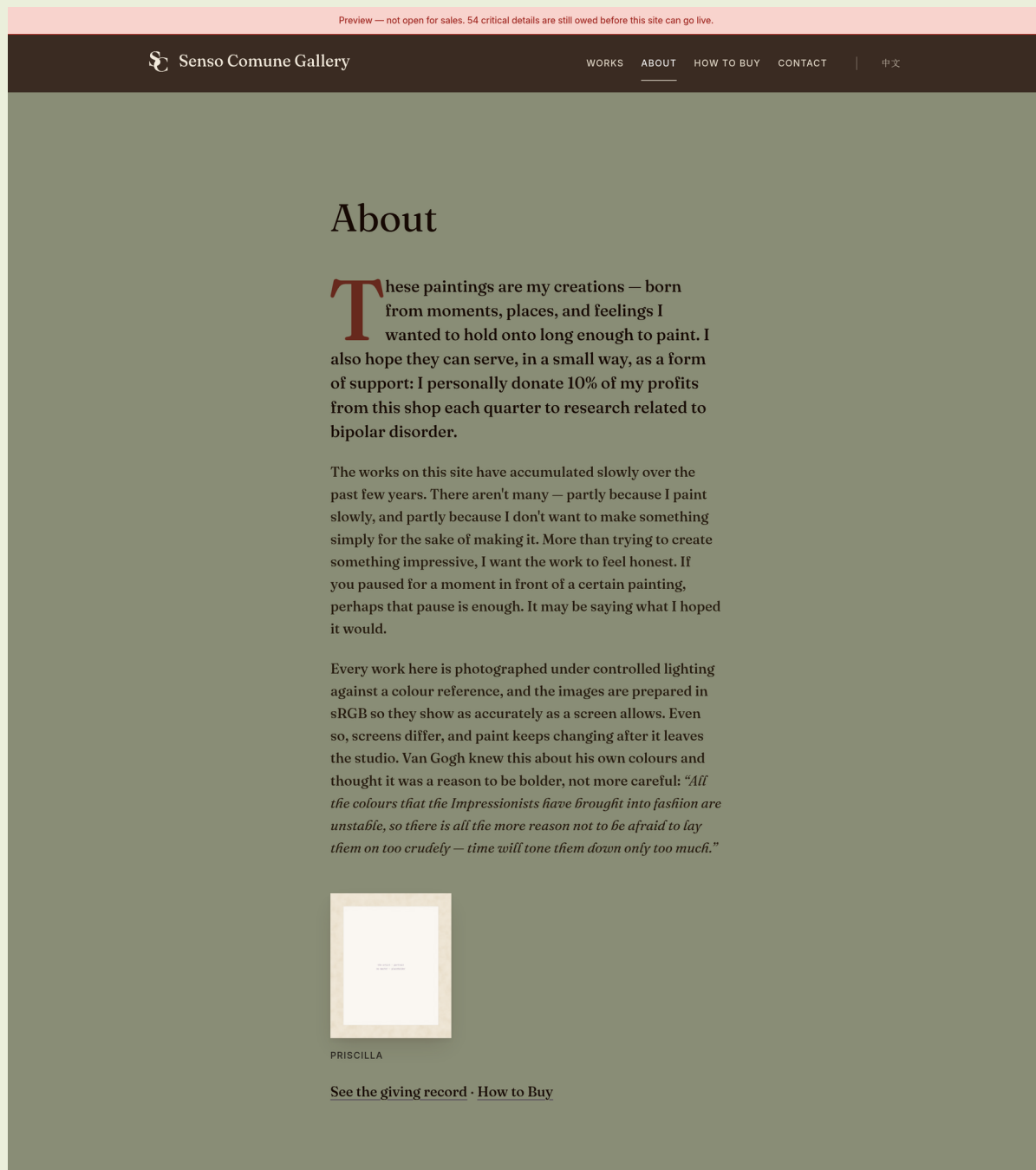


Figure 17: About, set as a book page: the display face at 19.2 px, a lede, a three-line drop cap in sanguine, and the closing quotation in Fraunces' real italic. The mount comes in to 660 px around a 34 rem column, and with its plate transparent it is the shadow and the rim that draw it. At the foot of the prose, the artist's portrait as a sign-off, matted as a painting is and holding the pipeline's placeholder card until the photograph exists (Section 2.7.8). The Chinese page is the same page in a system serif, without the drop cap or the italic (Section 2.3.3).



Figure 18: The homepage on a 390 px phone. The masthead takes two rows — the short name, then the sections and the language switch — and does not stick: a sticky masthead that tall would take a third of the screen and hide the focused item. Van Gogh's line comes before the featured work, and the painting is the full width of its column (Section 2.10).

Table 25: What the review changed, by group

Group	No.	What shipped
A Selling	4	A painting moved into the hero beside the motto; a <code>mailto:</code> link stopped calling itself <i>Buy</i> ; How to Buy gained reachable contact details; the price and its button were bound into one block
B Contrast and craft	4	A footer grey at 2.34:1 — shipped, not theoretical — was removed; the contrast checker was taught to resolve the cascade rather than read declarations; the scale diagram's linework went from 1.73:1 to 3.24:1 and its labels from 3.05:1 to 4.90:1
C Reach	4	The icon set, <code>theme-color</code> and manifest (Section 2.4); Open Graph typed as a product with price and availability; the sage field restored on a phone
D Reading	5	Prose pages given a narrower mount; the archive set as a grid rather than a second selling gallery; the gallery name made the <code>h1</code> ; dead rules deleted
E Fonts	2	The Chinese subset's coverage is now asserted at build time, and each locale preloads only the face it uses

Two were not fixes. **C-04** proposed freezing the wordmark in English; it was declined, and the wordmark still translates. That decision is what later freed the logo: a monogram is a device beside a name rather than a translation of one, which is why an SC mark can stand beside 常识画廊 (Section 2.4). And half of **B-03** was wrong: the scale diagram's painting and sofa were said to be off-axis, and are centred. Its contrast half was real, and is the measurement above.

Re-checked on 18 September against the review as written: all nineteen are accounted for. Eighteen shipped and every one of them is green in `check-review.mjs` under its own number; C-04 is recorded there as decided rather than done. **One part of one finding is still open** — A-02 asked for a WeChat route for the `zh` locale alongside the enquiry button, and the QR image that needs does not exist yet. The contact details it depends on are owed too (Section 5.5.4), so it is on the list in Section 7.2 rather than forgotten.

2.10 The second review, against the award

*20–21 September 2026. Eleven findings, coded AW-*nn*.*

The first review asked whether the site was correct. The second asked a different question — whether a design jury would stop on it — and it was conducted the same way: the site built, served, and laid out in headless Chrome at 390, 1024, 1280, 1440 and 1920 px in both locales, with every element box read out of the DOM rather than estimated from a screenshot. The findings are in `docs/review/`, with the boxes they were measured from, so a later reader can re-measure rather than take any of it on trust.

Its verdict was that the craft was here and the composition was not, and the single sentence under that was: **the system was built to hold paintings, and then configured never to show one at any size.**

Table 26: What the second review moved, measured

	Before	After
Featured painting, at 1440 and 1920	375 × 460	446 × 558
Price to its button	742 px apart	58 px, one column
Catalogue cell / image / caption at 1440	321 / 289 / 321	321 / 321 / 321
Latest works on a 390 px phone	208 px wide	307 px
Motto, 390 → 1920	38.4 px throughout	26.9 → 54.0
The work page's own painting	465 px	562 px
Masthead controls leading nowhere	3	0
Readiness blockers	57	54

The wall. Every painting on the site was held under a constant — `clamp(260px, 48vh, 460px)` in the hero, 22 rem in the catalogue, 16 rem in the archive, 14 rem on a series card. A work was therefore the same size on a 27-inch display as on a 13-inch laptop, and *smaller* on a phone than its own column had offered: a 40 × 30 portrait in a 307 px column wants 409 px, hit the 352 px cap and shrank to 264 wide. A cell is now a piece of **wall**: a box whose proportion is `--wall-ratio`, the narrowest work in the catalogue, which `build.js` derives from the data rather than anybody typing it. Every painting is width-bound and hangs to the bottom-left of its cell, so one left line and one right line run down the page and the tombstones stay level because the walls are. A landscape work entering the catalogue widens the wall for everyone, which is correct: the wall is whatever holds the work.

The opening screen. It spent its first 556 px on a masthead, a band and a label, and then showed a painting 12.5% of the screen wide with 65% of its own block empty beside it. The featured work now stands on a wall of its own proportion with its label at its foot — the work page's idiom brought forward — and the tombstone row is back inside the 32 rem the base rule has always capped it to and always explained.

Three things came out. The masthead's search, account and cart (Section 6.4); the band's four decorative rules (Section 2.7.7); and, in `check-review`, four `opsz` values pinned to sizes that had become fluid. Each removal is held by the assertion that used to hold the thing in place — N-01 holds the ornament *out* of the band now, and H-01 holds the shop bar to its route list in both directions.

Endings. A work page closed on a rule and one right-aligned *Next work*: no route back to the catalogue, nothing from the same series, nothing else at all. It closes with three works now — siblings first, newest first, only ones still for sale — and those three carry their view-transition names, so clicking one flies it out of the grid into the page it leads to. `check-review` H-05 said "one name per work page", which was the same thing as the rule that actually matters only while a work page showed one painting; it asserts what matters now — every name on the page distinct, the page's own exactly once, and never on a detail, an edge, a back or the video.

The share card. `og:image` pointed at the painting's own file, and a 4:5 canvas under `summary_large_image` is shown as a 1.91:1 sliver of itself whatever the page declares — while the home page, Works, every series and the archive declared a 1600 × 1600 square for a 1600 × 2000 file, because only the work page wrote a height at all. The card is drawn rather than cropped now: 1200 × 630, the sage wall, the painting in its mat, the monogram

beside it, one per work from the same master the pages use. No text on it, because text needs a font the SVG rasteriser can load and CI has no Fraunces, while every platform already sets `og:title` beside the image. Its colours are read out of `tokens.css`, like this report's figures, so the card cannot drift from the site it pictures.

And one bug that predates both reviews. `og:image` was the only absolute URL on the page built from a raw path rather than through `path()`, so on a project site served from `/<repo>/` — which is exactly what the GitHub Pages preview is — it lost the prefix that canonical, `og:url`, `hreflang` and every sitemap entry kept, and the card 404'd for every scraper that fetched it.

Nine of the eleven findings are closed. **AW-05** — which measured what the flat page costs, and put the plates back — was reversed the next day by decision, and Section 2.2.4 is the settlement: the bill it measured is printed on every build, and the half of the problem it did not solve, weight, is Section 2.3.7. **AW-10** waits on the shoot: the prose pages carry no image because there is no photograph to put on them, and an empty mat on a page that does not need one yet is worse than white space.

2.10.1 Looking at the pages

A last pass over every page type at three widths in both locales, which found six things that were wrong rather than arguable. They are recorded because each one had survived the measured reviews: **a measurement finds what you thought to measure, and looking finds what you did not.**

- The **404** named search, accounts and the cart as the things still being built, after the controls that led there had gone.
- `.link-quiet` was an `inline-flex`, so the arrow in `::after` was a flex *item*: a label that wrapped left it stranded, centred between the two lines and 240 px right of its own words.
- On a phone the **work page's own painting** was the only thing not on the column line — everything else at x34 across 307 px, the painting at x50 across 275, from 16 px of side padding kept for a shadow that is cast downward.
- **"Original Works"** wrapped: the section head's first track was 28 ch of Inter for a heading set in Fraunces at three times the size, which is 298 px of track for 361 px of words.
- The **filter tabs** scroll with the scrollbar hidden, which is fine until one does not fit: at 390 px *Sold works* sat off the right edge, including on the sold works page, where it is the tab that says where you are.
- The **prose column** was 303 px from the left of a 1440 px screen and 478 from the right. 860 px was "close around the measure", which was close enough while the mount was a painted sheet and the remainder read as margin; with the plate transparent there is no sheet and no margin, only an off-centre page.

PART 3

Money

3.1 Paying

3.1.1 The constraint

Stripe is not available

Mainland China is absent from Stripe's supported business countries. Hong Kong, Singapore and Japan are present. This is not the narrower finding about PayPal — it is the whole account.

Airwallex looked like the answer and is more restricted than it appears. A mainland entity can open an account for Global Accounts, foreign exchange and transfers, but card acquiring is excluded in Airwallex's own Chinese-language terms, and it opens no personal accounts at all.

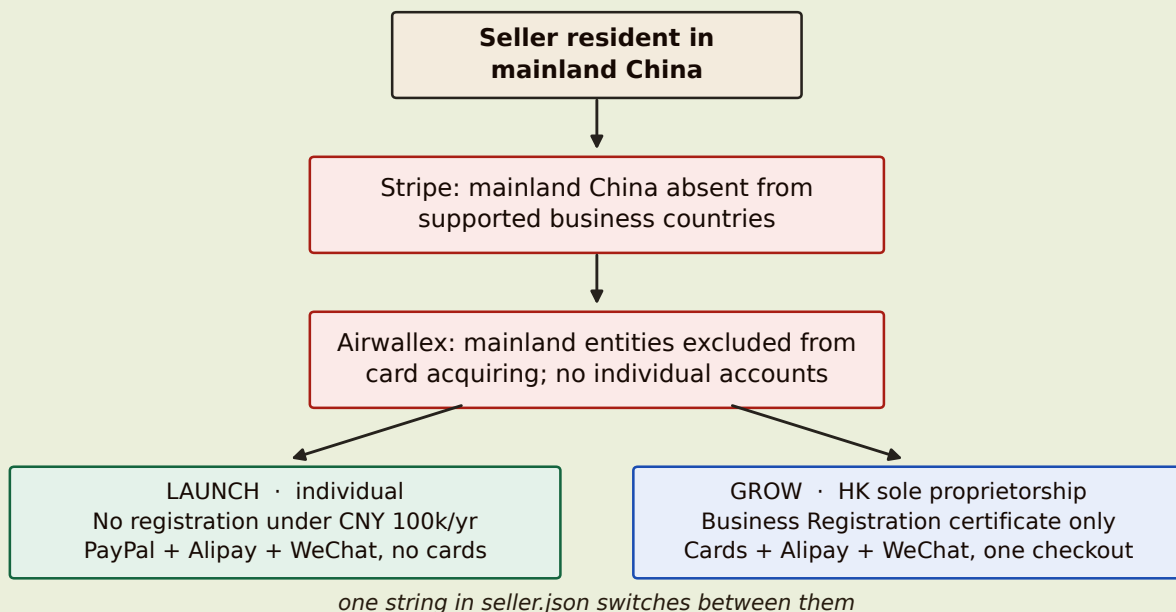


Figure 19: The two routes, and the one string that switches between them.

3.1.2 Route A — launch as an individual

At this turnover, four obligations that would normally apply do not.

Table 27: What the individual route does not require

Requirement	Position	Authority
Business registration	Not required under CNY 100,000/yr online turnover	SAMR Order 37, Art. 8 ¶13
FX annual quota	Not consumed — cross-border e-commerce settles outside it	汇发〔2020〕14号 Art. 66(2)
BOP declaration	Not filed — resident individuals exempt at or below USD 10,000 per transaction	汇发〔2022〕22号 Art. 8
VAT	Exempt — monthly sales under CNY 100,000, to 31 Dec 2027	财政部/税务总局 2023 年第 19 号

Six works at \$60–\$440 is roughly CNY 19,000 — an order of magnitude below the registration ceiling.

What Priscilla must not do

Route sale proceeds as a gift or family remittance; split transactions to stay under a threshold; or use informal currency swaps. The last is 私自买卖外汇 under Article 45 of the FX Regulations, and published enforcement puts the penalty on the offender's PBOC credit file.

3.1.3 Route B — a Hong Kong sole proprietorship

A Business Registration certificate is sufficient — no incorporation. That unlocks the free Airwallex plan with no-code payment links, international cards at 3.60% + HK\$2.35, **and Alipay and WeChat Pay** as merchant methods, which is how the domestic half of the audience is served from one checkout.

It also unlocks repatriation: Airwallex supports local CNY transfer for sellers without a mainland registered business whose ultimate beneficial owner is a Chinese national exporting goods from the mainland. That describes this business exactly.

Confirm before incorporating

Airwallex approves its Payments product **separately** from account opening, and reviews the live site as part of that review. The entity list verified covers account opening only.

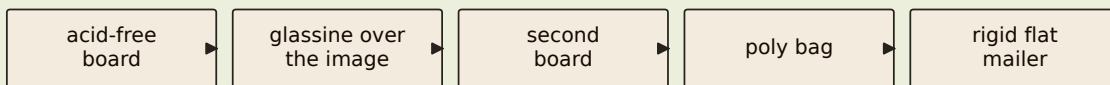
3.1.4 Rejected

Payoneer Checkout is Stripe-powered, excludes mainland China explicitly, and requires monthly volumes above USD 20,000 — roughly 130× this business. **PingPong** and **Lian-Lian** both have real independent-site acquiring, but neither publishes pricing or eligibility and both are sales-led. Do not design around either without a written quote.

3.2 Shipping

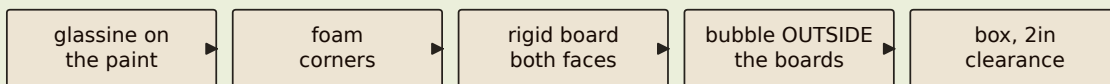
Works on paper

flat, never rolled — rolling cracks the sizing



Stretched canvas

upright, never flat — and never below freezing



Materials run \$25–50 per shipment. Every carrier's artwork declared-value cap sits above this inventory.

Figure 20: How each kind of work travels. The paper rule is the one most often got wrong.

Works on paper ship flat, never rolled

Rolling cracks the paper's sizing and can crease or smear the media. Tubes are a fallback for very large **unstretched** canvas only.

Stretched canvas ships upright, never flat, with the bubble wrap outside the rigid boards so nothing touches the paint. Cold is a real hazard: linseed oil stiffens and can crack below freezing, which matters for winter shipping.

The much-discussed "\$1,000 artwork cap" does not bind here. FedEx caps declared value on art at \$1,000 or \$9.07/lb, whichever is greater; USPS additional insurance for artwork caps around \$1,000. Every one of those caps sits above this entire inventory.

3.3 Duty and tax at the border

The site cannot say “duty-free” to US buyers

Original paintings under HS 9701 carry a **Free** base rate, which is where the belief comes from. For a **China-origin** shipment in 2026 it is wrong.

- **Section 301 List 4A applies.** HTSUS 9903.88.15 imposes **+7.5%** on products of China, and US note 20(s)(i) enumerates 9701.91.00 — contemporary paintings — among the covered subheadings. The exclusion that once covered paintings is expired.
- **De minimis is suspended.** The \$800 exemption no longer applies, so every painting needs a customs entry.
- **The IEEPA tariffs are gone** — struck down and revoked in February 2026 — and artworks were separately carved out of them as “informational materials”. That relief does **not** extend to Section 301.

A \$300 painting, China origin, delivered to the United States



Figure 21: What a US buyer actually pays on a \$300 painting.

Table 28: Import treatment by destination

Destination	Duty	VAT / tax	Confidence
United States	+7.5% Section 301	—	Verified
United Kingdom	0% , ERGA OMNES (origin-neutral)	Reduced art rate	Verified
European Union	0% expected	Reduced art rate per member state	Unverified — see Section 7

3.4 The donation pledge

The draft said “10% of each order goes toward research”, which is a per-transaction consumer promise. The site now says “*I personally donate 10% of my profits each quarter*” — a personal pledge, which is a materially different representation.

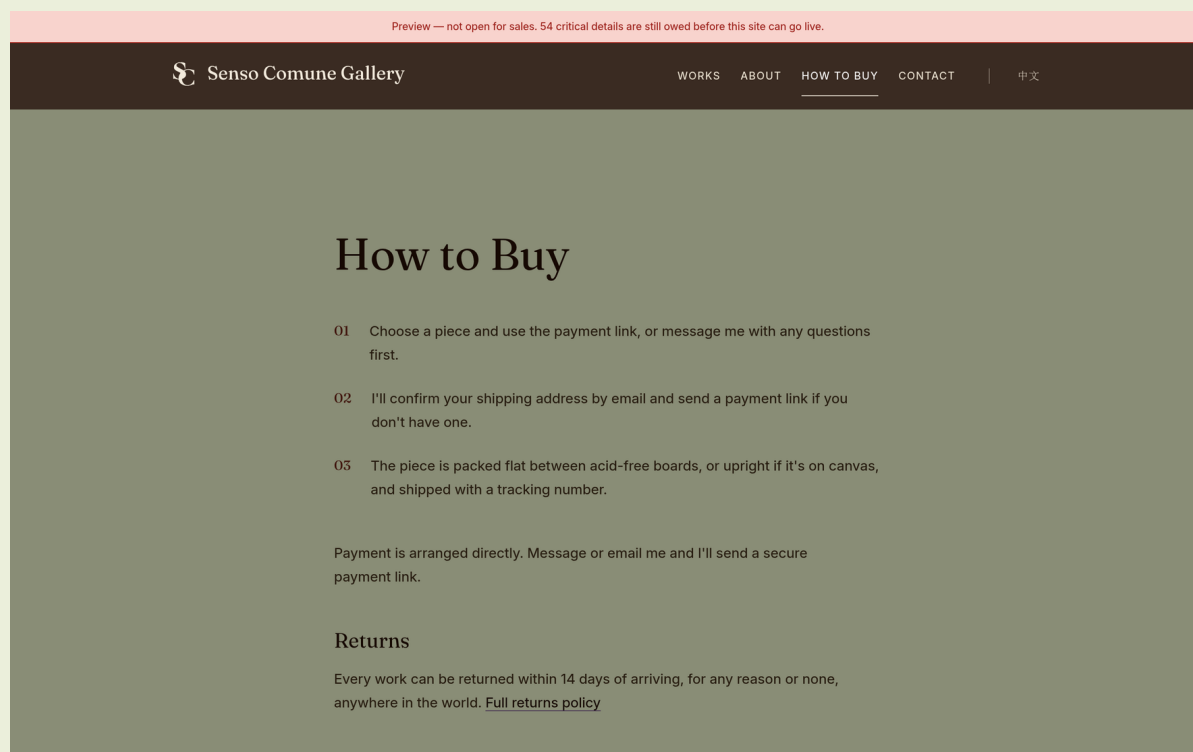


Figure 22: The How to Buy page, which puts the duty figure in front of the buyer before they commit rather than after.

What protects the pledge is not the wording but the receipts: a public page with the recipient named, the basis stated, the cadence disclosed, and a running cumulative total.

PART 4

Law and access

4.1 Returns

Returns cannot be refused, in either market

China. Consumer Protection Law Art. 25 gives a seven-day no-reason return on distance sales. The exceptions are a **closed list** — SAIC Order 90 Art. 6 excludes only goods made to the consumer's order, perishables, unsealed digital media and delivered periodicals. The 2024 Implementing Regulations Art. 19 then expressly forbid a trader expanding that list, and ban pre-ticked exclusion.

European Union. CRD Art. 16(c) excepts goods "made to the consumer's specifications or clearly personalised". **Uniqueness is not personalisation** — the test is whether the *buyer* specified it. A pre-existing painting chosen from a catalogue fails that test.

A "governed by PRC law" clause does not help: Rome I Art. 6(2) prevents a choice of law from depriving a consumer of protections that cannot be derogated from under their home law, where the trader directs activity there. Offering EU shipping at checkout is directing activity.

One worldwide 14-day policy over-satisfies the Chinese seven days, removes any need to geo-detect buyers, and avoids a seven-day policy reading as an attempt to shorten the EU right. Commissions are the one genuine exception under both regimes.

4.2 Disclosure

One block of address, phone and email satisfies three regimes at once: the EU Consumer Rights Directive Art. 6(1)(c), the Chinese requirement, and the UK anticipatory duty. Alongside it, SAMR Order 37 Art. 12 prescribes the exact sentence an unregistered individual seller must publish:

个人从事零星小额交易活动，依法不需要办理市场主体登记

That string is quoted verbatim from the rule and must not be paraphrased.

4.3 Privacy

PIPL applies, and costs a privacy page and a one-page impact assessment — no more. Processing necessary to conclude and perform the sale needs **no consent checkbox** — a just-in-time notice at the email field is the correct pattern, and consent is reserved for the newsletter. No PRC representative and no regulator filing are required, because those provisions bind handlers *outside* China. The overseas hosting is exempt from the CAC transfer mechanisms both as contract-necessary and on volume.

4.4 Accessibility

4.4.1 The legal position

Calmer than the compliance industry suggests. A one-person operation is almost certainly exempt from the European Accessibility Act as a microenterprise providing services. The stronger argument for the work is commercial: **a blind collector who cannot read the descriptions cannot buy the painting.**

4.4.2 What was built

Table 29: Accessibility work, by criterion

Criterion	What it required	Status
1.4.3 Contrast	Every CTA was 2.67:1	Filled ink control at 16.51:1 , and every text pair re-solved for the wall (Section 2.3.1)
1.4.1 Use of colour	No accent reaches 3:1 against body text	Underlines on body links, structurally
2.4.7 / 1.4.11 Focus	A single-colour ring dies over a dark painting	Two-tone ring, works on any ground
2.4.11 Focus not obscured	Sticky nav can hide the focused item	<code>scroll-padding-top</code> ; static on mobile
2.5.8 Target size	Nav bars are not sentences; the inline exception does not apply	48 px via padding
1.1.1 Non-text content	Six paintings, no alt text	Three-layer description per work
2.4.4 Link purpose	Six identical “Buy” links in the links list	Visually-hidden span per control

1.4.3, re-solved on a ground that moved twice

For part of 20 September this criterion did not hold. The reading plates went transparent and the wall went darker, and between them body text, captions and links ended up on a mid-tone at 1.98:1, 1.69:1 and 1.95:1 — below 4.5:1, and below 1.4.11's 3:1 for the muted pair (Table 6).

It holds again, and not by putting the plates back: the ink ladder was re-solved for the wall the same evening (Section 2.3.1). --body is **4.92:1** on it, --muted 4.62:1, links take the ink at 5.71:1, and the non-text tier clears 3:1. Two structural consequences came with it — the lit fall was flattened, because at its foot no ink of any colour could pass, and the terracotta accent was demoted to fills, rules and large text, because no red-brown that is still a red-brown reaches 4.5:1 on sage.

The check no longer reports this; it enforces it. With the plates off, the wall is one of the grounds `check-contrast.mjs` solves every foreground against.

4.4.3 Describing a painting

The “125-character limit” is folklore — there is none in the HTML specification or in WCAG. The citable number is Cooper Hewitt’s **approximately fifteen words**.

The guidance genuinely disagrees on interpretation: the DIAGRAM Center says never interpret, Cooper Hewitt says interpret when it aids visual understanding. For an artist’s own gallery Cooper Hewitt is right — but interpretation stays textually separable, labelled “Artist’s note”, placed last, and never allowed to replace observation.

On AI-drafted descriptions

Acceptable as a first pass, never as shipped text. A model can report palette, format and apparent handling. It cannot know the true medium, the real dimensions, the title, or the intent — which is exactly what a buyer needs. A wrong description is worse than none, because it burns trust in the channel.

PART 5

The build

5.1 Shape

Plain Node, no framework. Thirty-six pages generated from three data files, with **one npm dependency** — *sharp*, and only for turning photographs into web derivatives — which is the only architecture consistent with a design whose argument is restraint. Generating the pages needs Node and nothing else.

Three other things in this repository do need Python, and say so rather than pretending otherwise: the icon build, the image tool (Section 5.1.2) and this document. All three want Pillow; the report also wants matplotlib, fontTools and CairoSVG, and the image tool's trace mode wants VTracer. None of them is needed to build or check the site, with one exception noted in Section 5.4.

src/data/	site.json · seller.json · artworks.json	
	readiness-waivers.json	signed exceptions to the gate
src/styles/	tokens.css · base.css · gallery.css	
src/scripts/	gallery.js	the work-page views, enhanced
src/templates.js		
build.js	36 pages, two locales, and the 404	
brand/	mark-lockup.png	the artwork, as supplied, and
	brand-sheet.png	the sheet it came on
scripts/	build-icons.py	the icon set, cut from it
	image.py	vectorize · rasterize · selftest
	mark.mjs · mark-paths.js	the interim construction, now
		drawn only by this report
	build-fonts · build-fonts-cjk · build-images · build-icons	
	readiness · check-readiness · test-readiness · release	
	check-contrast · check-links · check-review · check-render	
	preview.mjs	one page, inlined, for review
docs/	brief/ · report/	

The page count follows the data: eighteen pages per locale for six works in two series, of which six are work pages.

5.1.1 The code assets carry their own hash

20 September 2026.

A page and its stylesheet are two requests, cached separately, and each host decides for how long. GitHub Pages — the preview target — sends `max-age=600` on both and does not read `_headers`. So for ten minutes after a deploy a returning visitor can be handed the previous `/styles.css` with the current `/index.html`: not a stale site but a **wrong** one, whose two halves disagree in a way that looks exactly like a change that failed to ship. It was read as one on 20 September 2026.

The three code assets — the stylesheet and the two scripts — are therefore written before any page, under names that contain a hash of their own bytes (`styles.cd55845f.css`), and each page names the files it was built against. A name that contains the bytes cannot be served for other bytes: old page with old stylesheet, together, until the page expires; new page with new stylesheet, at once. Nothing here shortens the ten minutes — no file in this repository can, on a host that ignores `_headers` — but whatever a visitor is holding is internally consistent. On Cloudflare Pages, which does read `_headers`, the same names earn the three of them a year, *immutable*.

Three assertions hold it, and the third is the one worth reading:

- every reference on every built page carries a hash, each resolves to a file, and **no plain-named copy is left in `dist/`** for a stale page to find;
- the hashed names are frozen for a year and `availability.json` is still 60 seconds — the one file at the root that must not be frozen, because it is how a page finds out it has sold;
- `availability.js` works out the deployment base by stripping its own filename off its own `src`, so that one file serves a domain root and a Pages subpath. The hash broke that expression. The base became the whole script URL, the sold check fetched `/availability.<hash>.jsavailability.json`, and the 404 landed in the `catch` that is there for being offline — so every sold work would have gone on showing as for sale, with nothing in the console to say so. The expression is now solved in the check against the name the build actually writes, at a root and under a base path.

Which is the general lesson, and it is cheap to state: content-addressing a file changes its name, and **everything that parses that name is part of the change** — here, the sold check, `check-review.mjs`, which finds the stylesheet in order to read it, and `preview.mjs`, which inlines it into a single-file review copy. Each of them now takes the name from the page rather than assuming it.

5.1.2 Converting between a drawing and pixels

`scripts/image.py` (`npm run image`) is the one place the project converts between the two, in both directions, and it states what each conversion costs instead of choosing quietly:

Mode	What you get
<code>pixel</code>	True vector geometry — every decoded pixel as an integer-aligned rectangle, horizontal runs merged. No quantization, smoothing, denoising, recolouring or resampling, and no compression either: large, and exact
<code>embed</code>	The original file, byte for byte, inside an SVG <code><image></code> . Visually lossless and honest about being a raster in a vector wrapper
<code>trace</code>	VTracer infers regions and paths. Compact, and an approximation — which is what <code>--verify</code> is for
<code>rasterize</code>	SVG or SVGZ back to a raster at a stated size, optionally flattened onto a colour, because alpha is the commonest thing to lose by accident

The output format is chosen by the **extension**, so the name of a file and its contents cannot disagree: `.svg .svgz .pdf .ps .eps` on the vector side, `.png .webp .jpg .tif` on the raster

side. The geometry is always built as SVG; PDF, PS and EPS are that SVG handed to Cairo, which is a container change and not a second approximation. Two things follow and are said rather than discovered: the `<metadata>` audit block only survives in the SVG containers, because PDF and PostScript have nowhere to keep it, and a pixel-mode page of a million rectangles is a million rectangles in PDF too — for print, trace or embed is almost always what is wanted. A format that cannot carry alpha, such as JPEG, refuses an image that has some until `--on` says what it should sit on.

The input file is never written to, and every output carries a `<metadata>` block naming its source, that source's SHA-256 and the mode, so a derived file can always be traced back. `--verify` renders the result back at native size and reports per-channel error, composited over black and over white as well as raw, because a renderer may legitimately rewrite RGB wherever alpha is low.

It has a `selftest`, and `npm run check` runs it: two fixtures — flat runs, a single pixel against a run, and partial alpha — both directions, requiring byte-exactness when the source is opaque and one unit per channel when it is not. A tool nobody re-tests is a tool that quietly stops working before the day somebody needs it.

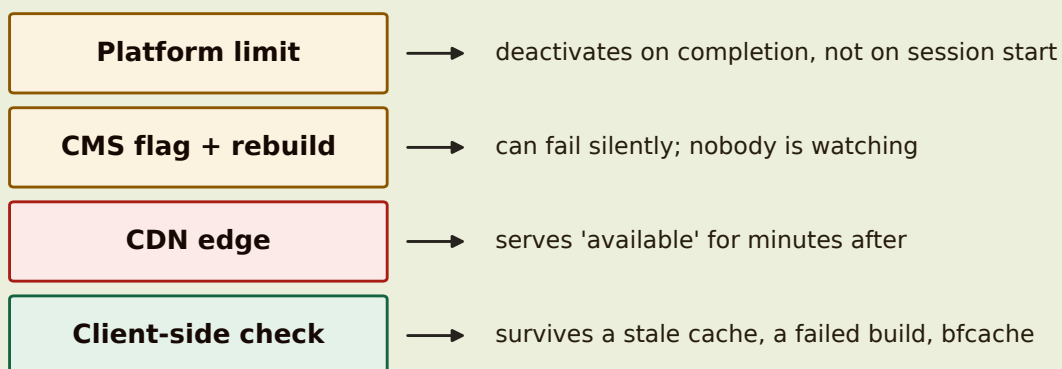
5.2 The entity switch

One string in `seller.json` moves the whole site between the two commercial routes:

```
"activeEntity": "individual" → "hk-sole-prop"
```

That switches the published legal disclosure, the invoicing language, the checkout provider and the returns basis together. No template knows which entity is active.

5.3 Overselling



No platform in this price range guarantees atomicity. The bottom layer is the cheapest, and the only one that survives the other three failing.

Figure 23: Defence in depth. Each layer above the bottom one fails in a way the bottom one survives.

No platform in this price range guarantees atomicity. The client-side availability check is roughly forty lines and is the only layer that survives a stale CDN page, a silently failed rebuild or a bfcache restore.

Alongside it, a published policy costs nothing and settles the residual case: *in the rare event two people buy the same piece at once, the first completed payment stands and the second is refunded in full within 24 hours.*

5.4 Checks that block the build

`npm run check` runs the first four in seconds. The rendering check needs Chrome; GitHub runs it on every preview, and the release runs all of them.

One of the four reaches outside Node: `check-review` ends by running the image tool's own selftest, which is Python. That was a deliberate choice over letting it skip when Python is bare — a check that can quietly not run is not a check — and the CI workflow installs the four wheels it needs so that it always does.

Table 30: The checks

Check	What fails it
<code>check-contrast</code>	Any token below its floor on the darkest ground it is painted on — resolving the cascade, so the declaration that actually wins is the one measured — and the glass bar under 7:1 over white. With the plates off it also prints, without blocking, every pair as the page actually renders it (Section 2.2.3)
<code>check-links</code>	A dead link; missing <code>alt</code> , <code>width</code> or <code>height</code> ; heading order; landmarks; hreflang; a Chinese character the font subset does not cover; a placeholder route that resolves. In a release, any <code>NEEDS-INPUT</code> or placeholder at all
<code>check-review</code>	99 assertions over 62 findings — both design reviews, the mark, softness, the header and the views, the structure, the flags and the gate — written against the built pages, so a fix that stops being applied fails the build
<code>test-readiness</code>	Any of 48 tests showing the gate opens only when it should (Section 5.5.3)
<code>check-review, last assertion</code>	The image tool failing its own round-trip: two fixtures, both directions, byte-exact when the source is opaque and within one unit per channel when it is not (Section 5.1.2)
<code>check-render</code>	In Chrome, at 1440, 900, 390, 360 and 320 px across 12 pages: a painting out of its own proportions, rounded or transformed; a masthead that overflows, takes more than two rows or has a control under 44 px; either half of van Gogh's line re-wrapped, its attribution off the quote's edge, or the featured work ahead of the quote

Headless Chrome will not lay a page out narrower than 500 px — asked for 390, it lays out at 500 and crops. Phone widths are therefore laid out inside an `iframe` of exactly that width, with scrollbars hidden, and the check asserts the width the page actually received.

A test that passes for the wrong reason

One of the review fixes set `font-size:var(--size-h1)`. No such token exists — the scale calls it `--size-hero` — so the rule silently fell back to inherited body size, and the assertion written for it passed because it only matched the declaration's text. The repair was a cross-cutting assertion that every `var(--token)` in the shipped stylesheet resolves to a definition. An undefined custom property is the one CSS error that produces no error.

The limit of automation

Automated testing decides roughly 13–30% of WCAG success criteria and catches almost none of the focus-order and focus-visibility failures that block people outright. The checks are a floor, not a pass.

5.4.1 A comment that closed twice

Worth recording, because it is the kind of failure a suite of 98 assertions can walk straight past. A comment in `tokens.css` had been closed twice: the second terminator ended it early, and everything after it — up to and including the declaration of `--sanguine` — was parsed as garbage and dropped by the browser. The site ran for a day without its accent colour: no terracotta focus ring, no filled button hover.

Nothing caught it. The token check greps the stylesheet's TEXT for the declaration, and the text was there. The contrast gate strips comments non-greedily before reading the tokens, and found it too. Every figure in this document that reads `tokens.css` read it the same way. Only a browser knew, and a browser is what found it: a decorative rule in the new band would not paint.

The assertion that would have caught it now exists — after stripping comments from each stylesheet, no orphan terminator may remain, and every declaration the raw file makes must still be present in what the parser would see. It is the cheapest kind of check and it holds a whole class of silent loss.

5.5 Readiness

The site must not go live until every critical detail is supplied. A list of fields marked NEEDS-INPUT is not enough to ensure that: an empty email, `test@example.com` or a placeholder photograph contains no such word, and a list that is printed does not stop a build that is published. The readiness gate checks what is in each field, and a release cannot be built while it is closed.

5.5.1 What the research says

- **Fail closed.** When a control cannot establish that it is safe to proceed, it should stop rather than carry on — the security principle usually called *failing securely*.⁷ For this site the unsafe state is a shop that looks open and is not lawful or not honest.

⁷OWASP, *Fail securely*.

- **The law names what is critical.** For distance sales to EU consumers, the trader's identity, geographical address, telephone number and email, the main characteristics of the goods, the total price and the arrangements for payment must all be given.⁸ China's E-Commerce Law requires the business licence information — or the statement that registration is not required — to be shown continuously in a prominent place on the homepage.⁹
- **Validate values, not words.** A real email address is best checked against the definition every browser uses, a deliberate, practical subset of RFC 5322.¹⁰ Some names are reserved precisely so they can never be real — `example.com`, `.test`, `.invalid`¹¹ — which makes an address on one an example nobody replaced. A telephone number in international form has a country code and at most fifteen digits.¹² A WeChat ID is six to twenty letters, digits, underscores or hyphens, beginning with a letter.¹³
- **Gates must be visible.** A documented case from this month: a Cloudflare Pages production build failed, the previous version kept being served, and every check on the repository stayed green, so nobody knew.¹⁴ A gate on the host alone is necessary and not sufficient.

5.5.2 How it works

- **A rules engine over the data** (`scripts/readiness.mjs`): 28 rules, each with an area, a severity, the condition under which it applies, the fix, and the law or finding it rests on. It reads nothing and writes nothing, so the build, the report and the tests ask the same question.
- **Values, with the word as backstop.** Every critical field has a rule that checks what is in it; a final rule catches `NEEDS-INPUT`, `TODO`, `lorem ipsum` and the like anywhere no specific rule reaches, and reports only what no other rule already has.
- **Conditions.** Hong Kong registration numbers apply only while that entity is active; the transaction ceiling only once the cart takes payments; a donation recipient only while the pledge is above zero. A conditional rule *owns* its fields, so the backstop cannot block on a field its rule has deliberately set aside.
- **Undecided is not declined.** An optional channel is either a handle or `"`, which removes it from the site. Left as `NEEDS-INPUT` it is undecided, and blocks.
- **Preview by default; release by request.** Any build not explicitly a release is a preview: noindex on every page, a ribbon saying it is not open for sales and how many details are owed, and — while anything is owed — purchase controls that are drawn but cannot be used. A release asks the gate before building and again inside the build, which refuses *before* clearing the previous output.
- **Nothing of the preview survives a release.** In release mode the link check fails on a single `NEEDS-INPUT` anywhere — attributes and structured data included — on any placeholder photograph, video or asset, on the ribbon, and on any unusable button. Views without photographs are left out rather than shown.

⁸Directive 2011/83/EU on consumer rights, [Article 6\(1\)](#), points (a), (b), (c), (e) and (g); Article 9(1) for the 14-day withdrawal period.

⁹中华人民共和国电子商务法, [第十五条](#).

¹⁰WHATWG HTML Standard, [valid e-mail address](#).

¹¹[RFC 2606](#), Reserved Top Level DNS Names; see also [RFC 6761](#).

¹²ITU-T Recommendation [E.164](#).

¹³WeChat Help Center, [How do I set my WeChat ID?](#)

¹⁴[tallyfy/documentation #242](#): the pipeline stays green when the Cloudflare Pages build that publishes the site fails.

- **Waivers with an expiry.** A blocker that can wait may be waived with a reason, a name and a date; expired or unsigned waivers do not count, and every live one is printed in every report and written into the release. Identity, the registration disclosure, returns, prices, dimensions, photographs and payment links cannot be waived — a waiver naming one keeps the gate shut. That includes the Chinese registration declaration, which must match the rule's wording character for character (rule LG-01).
- **Loud where it matters.** The production host's build command is the release script, so a closed gate is never published; a *Release check* workflow runs the same script on GitHub and fails red with the report on the run's summary page, and the preview workflow shows the report on every run.

Table 31: The rules, by area

Area	Rules	Examples of what blocks
Identity and contact	6	An email on a reserved domain; a phone number without country code; an address in one language; a malformed WeChat ID; an optional channel left undecided
Legal	4	The SAMR declaration edited by a single character; the Hong Kong entity active without its numbers; returns under 14 days; a pledge with no recipient
The site	2	An <code>example</code> or <code>http</code> site address; a header control that leads to the 404
Works and prices	7	No work for sale; a title as <i>TODO</i> ; alt text as an ellipsis; a price of 0; a currency that is not ISO 4217; a work dated next year; a payment link over <code>http</code>
Photography	3	A work for sale still showing its placeholder; a real view photograph with no description
Payments	3	No way to pay on the active entity; a cart taking payments with no transaction ceiling. PY-02 used to infer the cart's existence from a missing placeholder route, which stopped being true the day the control came out because there is no cart; <code>site.shop.cart</code> states it instead
Backstop	1	A placeholder in any field no rule names

5.5.3 How it is proved

- **The gate opens when it should.** A copy of the data with every critical detail supplied passes; 32 single breakages each close it on the named rule; five waiver cases — valid, expired, unsigned, scoped to another field, and aimed at a rule that cannot be waived — each behave as specified. 48 tests, in `npm run check`; weakening the 14-day rule or the reserved-domain list turns them red.
- **End to end, on completed data.** With the fields temporarily supplied and the three header placeholders of the time waived, the release ran: 0 blockers, 36 pages, no *NEEDS-INPUT* anywhere, no ribbon, all 40 purchase controls live, views without photographs omitted, the three waivers written into `readiness.json`, and every check green in release mode. The real data was then restored.

- **It refuses on today's data** — exit 1 at the readiness step — and assertion K-03 checks on every run that a refused release leaves the last built site untouched.

5.5.4 Today

The gate reports **54 blockers**: 36 in the works (titles, alt text and descriptions, in two languages), 5 photographs, 10 identity and contact details, the site's real address and the donation recipient. All of them are typing or photography, and none is a decision.

The three that were a decision are gone. SH-01 counted the header's search, account and cart, each leading to a page that does not exist; the second review took the controls out of the masthead altogether (Section 2.10), which closed the rule rather than waived it. It reopens the day a route is put back.

`npm run readiness` prints the list, each with the field, what is wrong, how to fix it and why it matters. On the preview, every placeholder a reader can see is also flagged in red on its own pale ground, and the flag goes the moment the field is filled; placeholders inside alt text, page titles and link previews cannot carry a flag and are on the printed list instead.

PART 6

The work page and the shop bar

Two requests, researched together because they meet on the same page: a work page that gives a visitor *enough views* of a painting, modelled on three reference shops, and the *search · account · cart* trio that sits top-right on nearly every shop. Five decisions were taken on 17 September 2026 (Section 6.4). The views are built; the buy box and the three shop pages are specified and not yet built (Section 6.6).

D1 has since been reversed, and the reversal is the interesting part. The three controls were built and shipped as placeholders, and the second review took them back out (Section 2.10): three e-commerce icons in the most valuable strip on the site, for a catalogue of six unique objects sold by enquiry, read as a store template rather than as a gallery — and all three were readiness blockers for the same underlying reason, a control that leads nowhere. Nothing was deleted to achieve it. The bar is built from `site.placeholders.routes`, which is now empty, so a route put back puts its control back with its icon, its accessible name in both languages and its 44 px target. Everything below stands as the specification for the day it is; what changed is only that the control now arrives **with** the page rather than ahead of it.

6.1 What the reference shops do

Table 32: Three reference work pages, as they stood in September 2026

	+ART Gallery (Shopify)	Saatchi Art	National Gallery of Art shop
Gallery	Left thumbnail rail: four stills and a fifth with a media badge	Left thumbnail rail: the work, a detail, two views in a furnished room	One image, no thumbnails
Size cues	Dimensions in the details	Dimensions; room views; web AR	Dimensions in the description
Buy box	Title, vendor, price with tax line; quantity stepper; add to cart; one-click wallet	Title, artist, medium, size, "ships in a tube"; price; instalments; add to cart; make an offer	Title, SKU, price; add to cart
Assurance	Payment-method badges; accordions for shipping, delivery, contact	Shipping included; 14-day guarantee; review score	None beyond price and tax
Pressure Share	"Hurry, only 1 left" bar Facebook, X, Pinterest	None visible Favourite count; add to collection	None Facebook, X, Pinterest
Header	Search field, log in, cart with count	Search, log in / register, cart with count	Search, log in, bag with subtotal

Saatchi's is the closest model for a painter: it is the only one whose thumbnails answer the question a buyer of a unique object actually has — *what will this look like on my wall?*

6.2 What the research says

Thumbnails, always. Every desktop site in Baymard's benchmark shows thumbnails for additional images; 76% of mobile sites do not. Where only dot indicators are shown, half of desktop test users had difficulty finding the additional images, and users missed the one that would have answered their question. On mobile, a partly visible last thumbnail signals that more exist.¹⁵

At least one image in scale. 42% of users try to judge a product's size from its images, and 28% of sites give them nothing to judge by.¹⁶ For a painting sold unframed, whose size is its single most consequential property after the image itself, this is the finding that matters most.

Different images answer different questions. Product-page guidance commonly separates a plain view, an in-scale view, a close-up of material and texture, and a view in use. For a painting those become: the front, a raking-light detail, the edge and back, and the work at true size on a wall.

¹⁵Baymard Institute, *Always use thumbnails to represent additional product images*.

¹⁶Baymard Institute, *Provide at least one "in scale" image*.

No auto-rotation, and real controls. The W3C pattern for a carousel requires a stop control whenever slides rotate on their own, stops rotation on focus and hover, and prefers a tab-style picker when slides are chosen directly — which is what a thumbnail rail is.¹⁷

Icons need words. Only the house, the printer and the magnifying glass are close to universally recognised; everything else — a person, a bag, a heart — is ambiguous without a visible label, and a label shown only on hover does not exist on a phone.¹⁸

Search should be as prominent as search is useful. Where people browse visually — Baymard’s examples are apparel and home décor, and art is the same kind of purchase — a small search control is right; dominant search fields belong to large catalogues bought by specification.¹⁹

Urgency must be true. EU law treats falsely claiming limited availability to rush a decision as unfair in all circumstances.²⁰ A unique work *is* available once, so a scarcity bar would not be false here — but the page already says *Unique work*, and a “Hurry” is pressure the brief rules out.

6.3 What is different here

A shop template assumes multiple units of many products, an account system and one checkout for everything in the cart. None of those is true of this site yet.

- **Every work is unique.** A quantity stepper has one legal value. “Only 1 left” is permanently true.
- **The catalogue is small.** Search earns its place only by finding what a visitor would actually type — a title, a medium, a year, a series — in either language, and nothing else.
- **There is no server.** The site is static by design. Accounts need authentication, password recovery and storage of personal data — which makes Priscilla a data controller under both PIPL and GDPR (Section 4.3) for nothing the buying path requires. The payment provider already holds the buyer’s record.
- **There is no multi-item checkout yet.** On the launch route each work has its own payment link, or is sold by enquiry. Whether a provider on either route can take several works in one hosted checkout is **not established** (Table 37).
- **A cart widens the overselling window.** Section 5.3 defends a unique work from being sold twice. A cart invites a buyer to believe a work is held while it sits there, and every layer of that defence has to re-check it.

6.4 The decisions

¹⁷W3C, [ARIA Authoring Practices Guide: Carousel pattern](#).

¹⁸Nielsen Norman Group, [Icon usability](#).

¹⁹Baymard Institute, [E-commerce search field design and its implications](#).

²⁰Directive 2005/29/EC, Annex I, point 7.

Table 33: The decisions of 17 September 2026

#	Decided	What it means
D1	Search, account and cart in the header now Reversed.	Each led to a placeholder route that landed on the 404. Built, shipped, and taken back out at the second review (Section 2.10): the controls return with the pages behind them
D2	Detail, edge, back and video views on every work	Placeholders until the photographs and video exist. The scale diagram stays beside the work rather than becoming a generated view
D3	Any number of works in one order	Limited only by availability and by the payment route's largest single transaction
D4	No search threshold	Search appears regardless of catalogue size, provided the query and the searchable text are correctly scoped
D5	Video on work pages only	Nowhere else on the site carries video

6.5 What is built

Figure 15 shows the result on a desktop.

- **The shop bar — built, then withdrawn.** Search, account and cart appeared on every page in both languages, as icons whose accessible names were the words (*Search, Account, Cart*; 搜索, 账户, 购物车), each destination a declared placeholder that check-links would fail the build over if it ever resolved. It is not drawn now (Section 2.10), and everything in that sentence is still true of it the moment a route returns: the markup, the icons, the names, the 44 px targets and the check are all in place and driven by the route list. On a phone the masthead takes two rows either way: the short name, *Senso Comune*; then the sections and the language switch. Below 360 px the name is kept for screen readers and the mark alone leads home.
- **Icons only, at every width.** The research above favours visible words; the reference Priscilla chose shows icons alone, and that is what was built. Only the magnifying glass is close to universal. If the account or cart icon proves ambiguous when the controls come back, the labels are one CSS change away: the words are already in the markup.
- **A bilingual 404.** Every placeholder lands on it: both languages, no canonical, not indexed, not in the sitemap. It named search, accounts and the cart as the things still being built until the controls went; what lands there now is a mistyped address, an old link and the footer's channel marks whose handles are owed, so it names none of them.
- **The five views.** Front, detail, edge, back and video on every work page, in a scroll-snap strip that swipes natively, with thumbnails always visible — a rail from 900 px, a row below that. It works with no script. A small script adds what links cannot: the current thumbnail marked for screen readers, no history entry per thumbnail, arrow keys, Home and End, and a video that pauses when it leaves the strip. Video is never preloaded and never plays by itself. Only the front view carries the painting between pages (Section 2.5).

- **Placeholders that step aside.** The image pipeline draws a labelled placeholder for each missing view at a sensible proportion; a real photograph replaces it on the next build and keeps its own proportions. A release leaves out any view without a photograph rather than showing its placeholder.

6.6 Still to build

Each item names the evidence that closes it; *done* means the check exists and passes, not that the page looks right. Sizes: S is under a day, M a few days, L a week or more.

6.6.1 The buy box and disclosures

- **Assurance from data, not copy.** Three lines under the action, each true and each already argued in this document: the worldwide 14-day return (Section 4.1); how the work is packed and insured (Section 3.2); and a link that estimates import duty for the buyer's country (Section 3.3) — which none of the reference shops offer, and which is the question an international buyer of a \$300 painting actually has.
- **Disclosures as native accordions:** Details, Shipping and packaging, Duty and import, Returns, Contact. No script, keyboard-operable, readable with styles off.
- **Payment methods from the active entity.** On the launch route that is PayPal, Alipay and WeChat Pay and *no card marks*. A card logo shown by a seller that cannot take cards is a misleading claim, so the list is generated, like the rest of the entity switch (Section 5.2).
- **Sharing that works in China.** The device's own share sheet where the browser has one, and *Copy link* everywhere — not Facebook, X and Pinterest buttons, all unreachable in mainland China. WeChat builds its own link card from the Open Graph tags the site already publishes.

Table 34: The buy box, item by item

Work	Done when	Size
Reorder the aside: price, action, assurance	The price is still the boldest element	S
Assurance lines generated from <code>seller.json</code>	No assurance string typed into a template	S
Duty estimate linked by destination	Every destination in Table 28 reachable	M
<details> disclosures	Operable by keyboard; content present with styles off	S
Payment methods from the active entity	Built with <code>hk-sole-prop</code> , card marks appear; with <code>individual</code> , none	S
Share sheet with copy-link fallback	Works with the API absent; no third-party share scripts	S
More works: three available, never sold	A sold work never appears	S

6.6.2 Behind the shop bar

Each is specified in the README (*Scripting still needed*). Building one means removing its placeholder route from `site.json`, which the link check and the readiness gate both require.

Table 35: The cart, search and account

Page	Work	Done when	Size
Cart	Works gathered on the device; a total held under the entity's <code>maxTransactionUSD</code> ; <code>availability.json</code> re-checked on open and before paying; several works paid in one payment where the provider allows it, otherwise work by work	A sold work is never counted in a total; no single payment exceeds the ceiling; a work in two carts cannot be paid for twice; order confirmation and withdrawal information reviewed against Section 4.1 and Section 4.2	L
Search	An index written by the build — title, medium, year and series, in both languages — searched in the browser, by substring so Chinese needs no word segmentation	English and Chinese queries both find titles and media; nothing outside the indexed fields matches	M
Account	A server, a login, password recovery and a privacy regime, for an order history the payment provider already has	Reasonable only if the site moves to a hosted platform that supplies accounts; not scheduled	—

6.6.3 Considered, and not planned

Table 36: Reference features left out

Feature	Status	Why
A generated in-scale view	Optional	Not taken under D2; the scale diagram already does the job beside the work
Web AR on the wall	Optional — <i>later</i>	Native Android AR viewers rely on Google Play services, largely absent in mainland China; in-browser AR needs a commercial platform
Make an offer	Optional	The enquiry already does this; a form needs a back end
Quantity stepper	Not recommended	One legal value
"Hurry, only 1 left"	Not recommended	True, but pressure; <i>Unique work</i> already says it
Instalment financing	Not recommended	Neither entity route has a lending partner

Feature	Status	Why
Review score	Not recommended at launch	No reviews exist; inventing them is unlawful

PART 7

Open items

Seven places where what is held is thinner than the decision resting on it. Every one needs a person outside this project — a customs broker, a tax adviser, a carrier, a payment provider, whoever drew the mark — and none can be closed by writing more code.

Table 37: Unresolved, in rough order of cost if wrong

#	Item	Status	What to do
1	Cultural-relics export appraisal	Not established. Chinese government sources unreachable	Confirm a living artist's new work is not 文物 before the first export
2	EU reduced art VAT rates	Unverified. Directive (EU) 2022/542 changed art VAT from 2025	Do not publish per-country rates yet
3	Carrier costs and insurance from China	No verified figures	Needed before the shipping page is final
4	Export declaration for a \$300 painting	Not established	Also determines what supports the bank's FX check
5	Airwallex + HK sole proprietorship	Entity list verified for account opening only	Ask before incorporating
6	Several works in one payment, and the largest single transaction	Not established on either route	Ask the provider in writing before the cart is built; the figure becomes <code>maxTransactionUSD</code>
7	The mark has no vector source	The whole supply is one 1536 × 1024 raster; the monogram is about 590 px of it. A one-colour vector has since been traced from it (Section 2.4.5), which answers the tab and any coloured ground — and cannot answer the interlock, because one colour cannot say which stroke passes in front	Ask whoever drew it for the vector, or a much larger scan. Nothing on the site needs it — a 180 px icon and a 2× masthead mark are inside the ceiling — but a business card, a 15 mm foil stamp or a gallery window each want it, the interlock wants it, and it costs nothing to keep with the rest (Section 2.4.4)

7.1 Settled in the build

Table 38: Questions the build answered, and where

Item	Resolution	Where
CJK webfont strategy	34 KB cut from a 24 MB face, gated by <code>unicode-range</code> , with Chinese body prose left to the system serif on purpose — and the one trap that follows, which is that the Chinese book page cannot use the display stack (Section 2.3.4)	<code>scripts/build-fonts-cjk.py</code>
Leonardo's hatching angle	Recorded in the stylesheet as a measurement rather than a citation, with the caveat that two chalk sheets ran the other way	<code>src/styles/base.css</code>
Mona Lisa glaze layer count	The thickness is cited; the count is not, and the comment says why	<code>src/styles/tokens.css</code>
A mark for two languages	An SC monogram — a device beside the name rather than a translation of it — used as the drawing Priscilla supplied, one crop serving the tab, the home screen, the masthead and this document	<code>brand/</code> , <code>scripts/build-icons.py</code>
A mark that can take a colour	The drawing reduced to one colour and traced — a second, declared object beside the artwork, measured against what it came from and re-derived by the checks. The tab has a shape again; the interlock is what one colour cannot carry (Section 2.4.5)	<code>scripts/build-mark-vector.py</code>
What the paper actually is	Measured off the artwork rather than chosen: 1/f spectrum, no weave periodicity, σ 4.87 of 255. A cold-press cotton-rag sheet, reproduced as one tile that cannot change a colour (Section 2.5.7)	<code>src/styles/tokens.css</code>
Converting between a drawing and pixels	One tool, both directions, the fidelity of each mode stated rather than chosen quietly, and its own selftest inside <code>npm run check</code> (Section 5.1.2)	<code>scripts/image.py</code>

Item	Resolution	Where
Whether her sage could carry the reading after all	Yes, and the failure was one-dimensional: lightness, not hue or chroma. The three grounds keep their measured lightness and rotate onto the field's hue, which cost no foreground token and improved every pair (Section 2.2.2)	src/styles/tokens.css
Whether a nine-rem fade needs a dither	No. Measured against the browser's own gradient dithering, the tile made the row-mean residual worse — 0.195 of 255 against 0.173 (Section 2.5.7)	src/styles/base.css
What a serif costs a page of prose	14.8 % of its reading size, if set at the sans's point size. Fraunces needs 19.2 px to match Inter's x-height at 16.8 — which is where the type scale already put it (Section 2.3.3)	src/styles/tokens.css

7.2 Content still outstanding

The 57 details in Section 5.5.4. The blocking ones that matter most are the photographs, the titles and descriptions, and the contact details — the email and phone are not optional; they are the consumer-law requirement in Section 4.2.

Four things that are not NEEDS-INPUT but are still owed:

- **The Chinese-locale enquiry route** should be WeChat rather than a `mailto:`, and that needs a QR image that does not exist yet. It is the one part of design-review finding A-02 still open (Section 2.9).
- **The social handles.** Six channels are drawn in the footer and none has an address yet, so each links to a route that does not exist and lands on the 404 page. Supplying a handle turns its mark into the real link; an explicit "" takes the channel off the site. Readiness rule ID-06 will not let a release build while any of them is undecided.
- **The artist's portrait.** About now carries a frame for it in both the places About appears (Section 2.7.8), and the frame is the only part that was missing: the photograph goes in `masters/portrait.jpg` and the build cuts it like any other. Until it exists the frame holds a labelled placeholder in previews and is left out of a release altogether, so nothing ships as an empty mat. Rule ID-08 reports it as omitted; rule ID-07 blocks a release the moment the photograph is real and its description is not.
- **The mark's vector source** — open item 7 above.

Appendix: sources and method

Colour. Ratios computed with the WCAG 2 relative-luminance formula. The draft’s values were extracted from the PDF content stream rather than sampled from a render, so they are declared values. Figures in this document read the project’s live token file.

Fonts. Built with fonttools 4.59.1 from the variable originals; byte counts are measured output, not estimates.

Reachability from mainland China. Measured against a GFW measurement service, with known-blocked controls validating the method before any result was accepted.

Regulatory material. Chinese provisions read from `gov.cn` and `safe.gov.cn`; EU instruments from the Publications Office; US tariff treatment from the HTSUS and the Federal Register. Article numbers are given so each can be checked.

Layout. Verified in headless Chrome at 1440, 900, 390, 360 and 320 px, not by description; phone widths are laid out in an iframe of the stated width, because Chrome will not lay a window out below 500 px (Section 5.4). The captures in Section 2.8 are taken from `dist/` by `docs/report/shots.sh` as part of this document’s build, so they cannot show a version of the site that is no longer shipping.

If this is printed. It is meant to be, so the things a printer asks for are settled rather than left to them.

Trim	A4, 210 × 297 mm. Set in <code>preamble.tex</code> , not in the front matter — Quarto passes neither <code>papersize</code> nor its <code>geometry</code> list to this template, and the document was US Letter for its whole life while every margin in it was given in millimetres. Found by measuring the PDF
Bleed	The sage band and the page canvas both run off the edge, so trim-size artwork is not enough. <code>npm run report:print</code> writes a second file, <code>-print.pdf: 230 × 317 mm</code> , the A4 trim centred in it, the edge artwork carried 3 mm past the knife, and crop marks 3 mm outside the trim and 4 mm long
Fonts	All embedded and subset — Inter, Fraunces, Noto Serif SC and the Latin Modern the maths uses
Colour	RGB. Ask the press to convert with a stated profile rather than converting it here blind; the palette is warm brown, sage and cream, which separates without drama
Images	Every figure is 285 ppi or better at its placed size, except three, all deliberate: the prototype sheet at 247, the lockup plate at 210 and the variations panel at 273 — all three are supply-limited (Section 2.4.4, open item 7) — and the small tiles inside Figure 8 and Figure 10 at 91, which are 16 px and 32 px renderings shown enlarged, where the pixels <i>are</i> the subject
Ink	The page is tinted edge to edge. For a long run on a press that charges by coverage, <code>\canvaspaperfalse</code> in <code>preamble.tex</code> gives white pages and keeps the sage band

A cross-reference that became a footnote number. Every `@sec-plates` in this document rendered as 1 for one build: a line inside a bullet list began (`@sec-plates`) the ground beneath , and in Pandoc a line that starts with (`@label`) followed by a space is an **example-list item**, not a reference. It defined an example called `sec-plates`, and from then on every reference to that label resolved to the example's number instead of the section. Nothing warned: the label was valid, the section was numbered, and the output was a plausible-looking numeral. Keep a parenthesised reference off the start of a line, or follow it with punctuation rather than a space.

The paper. This document's pages are the site's own reading surface, `--wash-pale`, flat. They carried the site's canvas tile until 20 September 2026; the site's reading surfaces are untextured now, so this one is too (Section 2.5.7). One 300 dpi image has left the underside of every page with it.

Figure quality. Page captures are taken at 2×, resampled to 1772 px — 287 dpi where they are placed — and kept **lossless**: a screenshot is type and UI edges, and since the site acquired a texture a JPEG artefact in a capture of it cannot be told apart from the texture itself. The photographic plates — the prototype sheet, the lockup, the variations panel and the page canvas — are JPEG at quality 95 with no chroma subsampling, which is the right codec for continuous tone and visually lossless at this size.

The mark. Figure 5 and Figure 6 are `brand/brand-sheet.png` and `brand/mark-lockup.png` reproduced as supplied, and the mark in this document's footer is the same crop of the lockup that the browser tab gets — the report imports the icon build's own cropping rule rather than repeating it, so the document, the tab and the masthead cannot be three different drawings. Both originals are pinned by hash (Section 2.4.2).

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